

STUDY NOTES · UPSSSC PET 2026

# UPSSSC PET General English

सम्पूर्ण अंग्रेजी नोट्स — Grammar, Vocabulary, Sentence Ability & Comprehension

4 अध्याय-फ़ाइल  
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# General English — Basic Grammar

## PET Detailed Notes | English-first | StudyHub Point

**Learning sequence:** Concept → Rule → Examples → Common Errors → Exam Tip → Practice

**Hindi Help:** कठिन या confusing points पर ही short Hindi support दिया जाएगा। बाकी explanation English में रहेगा।

## Part A — Parts of Speech

Parts of speech classify words according to their grammatical function in a sentence. A word must be identified from its **context and function**.

| Part         | Function                                               | Examples                |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Noun         | names a person, place, thing, animal, quality, or idea | teacher, Delhi, honesty |
| Pronoun      | stands for/refers to a noun or noun phrase             | he, she, they           |
| Adjective    | modifies/describes a noun or pronoun                   | honest, tall, three     |
| Verb         | expresses action, occurrence, or state                 | run, write, seem        |
| Adverb       | modifies a verb, adjective, adverb, or clause          | quickly, very, often    |
| Preposition  | expresses a relationship                               | in, on, between         |
| Conjunction  | connects words, phrases, or clauses                    | and, but, because       |
| Interjection | expresses sudden feeling                               | Oh!, Alas!              |
| Article      | marks a noun as general/specific                       | a, an, the              |

### Core Concept

**\*\*Context matters:\*\*** - **\*\*Fast\*\*** is an adjective in “a fast car”. - **\*\*Fast\*\*** is an adverb in “He runs fast”.

### 💡 Exam Tip

**\*\*Hindi Help:\*\*** Part of Speech = sentence में word का grammatical function.

## Part B — Nouns

A **noun** names a person, place, thing, animal, substance, quality, state, or idea.

### Types of Nouns

- **Proper:** Rahul, India, Monday
- **Common:** boy, country, city
- **Collective:** team, committee, crowd
- **Abstract:** honesty, beauty, courage
- **Material:** gold, water, milk
- **Countable:** book, apple, student
- **Uncountable:** advice, information, furniture, luggage

### ⚠ Warning

Do not normally write **\*\*advices, informations, furnitures, luggages\*\*** in standard English. Use: **\*\*a piece of advice, some information, a piece of furniture\*\***.

### Number

- Singular: book, child, woman
- Plural: books, children, women

## Important Irregular Plurals

| Singular | Plural   |
|----------|----------|
| man      | men      |
| woman    | women    |
| child    | children |
| foot     | feet     |
| tooth    | teeth    |
| mouse    | mice     |
| person   | people   |

## Possessive Nouns

- Rahul's book
- the boys' bags
- the children's toys

∴ trap Some words ending in **-s** can be singular in meaning: **news, mathematics**. Always judge from the sentence. ∴

## Part C — Pronouns

A **pronoun** is used in place of, or to refer to, a noun/noun phrase.

## Types

| Type          | Examples                                       |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Personal      | I, we, you, he, she, it, they                  |
| Possessive    | mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs           |
| Reflexive     | myself, yourself, himself, herself, themselves |
| Demonstrative | this, that, these, those                       |
| Relative      | who, whom, whose, which, that                  |
| Interrogative | who, whom, whose, which, what                  |
| Indefinite    | someone, anyone, nobody, each, several         |
| Reciprocal    | each other, one another                        |

## Antecedent Agreement

A pronoun should normally agree appropriately with its antecedent in **number and person**.

- Riya finished **her** work.
- The students finished **their** work.

## Who, Whom, Whose

- **Who** → subject/person performing an action.
- **Whom** → object in formal usage.
- **Whose** → possession.

Who called you?

Whom did you meet?

Whose book is this?

### 💡 Exam Tip

Formal test: if the answer would be **he/she**, use **who**; if **him/her**, **whom** may be appropriate.

## Part D — Adjectives

An **adjective** describes, identifies, or gives information about a noun/pronoun.

### Degrees of Comparison

| Degree      | Example |
|-------------|---------|
| Positive    | tall    |
| Comparative | taller  |
| Superlative | tallest |

Irregular forms:

- good → better → best
- bad → worse → worst
- little → less → least
- many/much → more → most

#### ⚠ Warning

Avoid double comparison: ⊗ more better ⊗ most tallest ✓ better ✓ tallest

### Order of Adjectives — Basic Rule

When several adjectives occur before a noun, a common order is:

**Opinion → Size → Age → Shape → Colour → Origin → Material → Purpose + Noun**

a beautiful small old round red Italian wooden table

This order is a guideline; natural English does not always require every category.

## Part E — Verbs

A **verb** expresses an action, occurrence, or state.

### Main Verb

She **writes** every day.

### Auxiliary Verbs

- **be:** am, is, are, was, were, been, being
- **have:** have, has, had
- **do:** do, does, did

### Modal Auxiliaries

| Modal  | Common meaning/use                      | Example                 |
|--------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| can    | ability/possibility                     | She can swim.           |
| could  | past ability/polite possibility/request | Could you help me?      |
| may    | permission/possibility                  | May I come in?          |
| might  | weaker possibility                      | It might rain.          |
| must   | strong obligation/deduction             | You must obey the rule. |
| should | advice/expectation                      | You should study.       |
| will   | future/willingness                      | I will help you.        |
| would  | polite request/hypothetical use         | Would you help me?      |

### Remember

After a modal, use the **base form (V1)**: - can **swim** - should **study** - must **leave** Not:  
⊗ can swims / ⊗ should studied

## Transitive and Intransitive Verbs

**Transitive:** takes a direct object in the construction.

She **opened the door**.

**Intransitive:** does not take a direct object in the construction.

The baby **slept**.

## Verb Forms

| Form    | Example |
|---------|---------|
| V1      | go      |
| V2      | went    |
| V3      | gone    |
| V-ing   | going   |
| V1+s/es | goes    |

::: trap After **did**, use V1: **Did he go?** not **Did he went?** :::

## Part F — Non-Finite Verbs

Non-finite verb forms do not show tense/person agreement in the same way as finite verbs.



## Infinitive

Usually **to + V1**:

I want **to learn**.

A bare infinitive is used after many modals:

You must **go**.

## Gerund

The **V-ing** form functioning as a noun:

**Reading** is useful.

## Participle

Participles can function in verb phrases or as modifiers.

- Present participle: **running** water
- Past participle: **broken** glass

∴ trap Do not treat every **-ing** word as a gerund. Its function in the sentence matters. ∴

## Part G — Adverbs

An adverb can modify a verb, adjective, another adverb, or an entire clause.

### Common Types

- Manner: slowly, carefully
- Time: now, yesterday, soon
- Place: here, there
- Frequency: always, often, never

- Degree: very, quite, too, almost

Examples:

- He runs **quickly**.
- She is **very** intelligent.
- He runs **quite** quickly.
- **Fortunately**, nobody was hurt.

### ⚠ Warning

Not every **-ly** word is an adverb. **Friendly** is commonly an adjective; **fast** can function as an adverb.

## Part H — Prepositions

A preposition expresses a relationship of time, place, direction, cause, manner, or another kind.

### Time

| Preposition | Common use            | Example            |
|-------------|-----------------------|--------------------|
| at          | exact time            | at 5 p.m.          |
| on          | day/date              | on Monday          |
| in          | month/year/period     | in July; in 2026   |
| since       | starting point        | since Monday       |
| for         | duration              | for two hours      |
| by          | deadline              | by 6 p.m.          |
| during      | within a period/event | during the meeting |

### Place and Direction

- **in** → inside
- **on** → surface

- **at** → point/location
- **into** → movement to the inside
- **under** → lower than
- **above** → higher than
- **between** → relation between separately identified entities
- **among** → within a group

## Commonly Confused Pairs

### In / Into

The child is **in** the room.  
The child went **into** the room.

### By / With

The poem was written **by** Tagore.  
He cut it **with** a knife.

### Beside / Besides

- beside = next to
- besides = in addition to

#### ⚡ Trick

**\*\*Besides = in addition.\*\*** **\*\*Beside = next to.\*\***

## Part I — Conjunctions

A conjunction connects words, phrases, or clauses.

## Coordinating Conjunctions

**FANBOYS:** For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So.

## Subordinating Conjunctions

because, although, if, when, unless, while, before, after, since, etc.

## Correlative Conjunctions

- either...or
- neither...nor
- both...and
- not only...but also
- whether...or

### Exam Tip

Correlative conjunctions should normally connect grammatically parallel elements. > She likes **\*\*both singing and dancing\*\***.

## Part J — Articles and Determiners

### Articles

#### A

Use **a** before a singular countable noun when the following sound is a consonant sound.

a book, a university, a European country

#### An

Use **an** before a singular countable noun when the following sound is a vowel sound.

an apple, an hour, an honest man, an MBA

### ⚡ Trick

**\*\*A/An depends on sound, not spelling.\*\***

## The

Use **the** when the noun is specific/identified and in several established expressions.

I saw a dog. **The dog** was barking.

**The sun** rises in the east.

## Zero Article

No article is often used with plural or uncountable nouns when speaking generally:

**Books** are useful.

**Water** is essential for life.

## Determiners

Determiners help identify or quantify nouns.

Common groups:

- Demonstratives: this, that, these, those
- Possessives: my, your, his, her, our, their
- Quantifiers: some, any, much, many, few, little, several, enough
- Distributives: each, every, either, neither
- Numbers: one, two, first, second

## Few / A Few / Little / A Little

- **few** → almost none; countable plural
- **a few** → some; countable plural
- **little** → almost none; uncountable
- **a little** → some; uncountable

Few students attended.  
 A few students attended.  
 There is little water left.  
 There is a little water left.

### ⚠ Warning

**\*\*Much/many:\*\*** much → uncountable; many → countable plural.

## Part K — Tenses

Tense/aspect expresses time and the way an event is viewed.

### 12-Tense Framework

| Time    | Simple       | Continuous        | Perfect        | Perfect Continuous     |
|---------|--------------|-------------------|----------------|------------------------|
| Present | V1 / V1+s/es | am/is/are + V-ing | has/have + V3  | has/have been + V-ing  |
| Past    | V2           | was/were + V-ing  | had + V3       | had been + V-ing       |
| Future  | will + V1    | will be + V-ing   | will have + V3 | will have been + V-ing |

### Present Simple

**Structure:** Subject + V1/V1+s-es

Uses: habits, routines, facts, general truths, suitable schedules.

He **goes** to school every day.  
 The sun **rises** in the east.

### Present Continuous

**Structure:** am/is/are + V-ing

She **is studying** now.

Used for actions happening around now, temporary situations, and suitable arrangements.

## Present Perfect

**Structure:** has/have + V3

I **have finished** my work.

Used for past events with present relevance, experiences, and certain situations continuing to the present.

∴ trap A finished past-time marker such as **yesterday** normally takes the past simple rather than present perfect.

⊗ I have seen him yesterday.

✓ I saw him yesterday. ∴

## Present Perfect Continuous

**Structure:** has/have been + V-ing

She **has been studying** for two hours.

## Past Simple

**Structure:** V2

They **visited** Agra last year.

## Past Continuous

**Structure:** was/were + V-ing

I **was reading** when he called.

## Past Perfect

**Structure:** had + V3

The train **had left** before we reached the station.

## Past Perfect Continuous

**Structure:** had been + V-ing

He **had been working** for three hours before the break.

## Future Simple

**Structure:** will + V1

I **will call** you tomorrow.

## Future Continuous

**Structure:** will be + V-ing

This time tomorrow, I **will be travelling**.

## Future Perfect

**Structure:** will have + V3

By Friday, she **will have completed** the work.

## Future Perfect Continuous

**Structure:** will have been + V-ing



By June, he **will have been teaching** for ten years.

### Formula

**Pattern memory:** - Continuous → **BE + V-ing** - Perfect → **HAVE + V3** - Perfect Continuous → **HAVE + BEEN + V-ing** - After **will** → **V1** - After **did** → **V1**

## Part L — Subject-Verb Agreement

The verb agrees with the grammatical subject in person and number.

### Core Rules

1. He **works** hard. / They **work** hard.
2. Intervening phrases do not normally change agreement: **The quality of these products is good.**
3. Each/every/everyone/everybody/someone/nobody normally take singular verbs.
4. With either...or / neither...nor, the verb commonly agrees with the nearer subject in standard exam constructions.
5. **along with, as well as, together with** do not normally make the main subject plural.
6. There **is** a book. / There **are** two books.
7. A collective noun can take singular or plural agreement depending on meaning and variety of English; follow the context and exam convention.

::: trap **Nearest noun ≠ automatically the subject.** Find the grammatical subject first. :::

## Part M — Sentence Structure

Understanding sentence structure helps with error detection, transformation, and comprehension.

### Phrase

A group of words functioning as a unit but normally without a finite verb.

in the morning

## Clause

A group of words containing a subject-verb relationship.

when he arrived

## Main Types of Sentences by Structure

### Simple

One independent clause.

She works hard.

### Compound

Two or more independent clauses joined appropriately.

She works hard, **and** she studies regularly.

### Complex

One main clause + one or more subordinate clauses.

She works hard **because she wants to succeed**.

#### Exam Tip

**\*\*Independent clause\*\*** can stand as a sentence. A **\*\*dependent/subordinate clause\*\*** cannot normally stand alone in the same way.

## Part N — Active and Passive Voice

### Active Voice

The subject performs the action.

The teacher **checked the answer**.

### Passive Voice

The grammatical subject receives the action.

The answer **was checked by the teacher**.

### Conversion Steps

1. Identify the active object.
2. Move it to passive subject position.
3. Choose the correct form of **be**.
4. Use V3.
5. Add the agent with **by** when useful.
6. Preserve tense and meaning.

#### Formula

**\*\*Active:\*\*** Subject + Verb + Object **\*\*Passive:\*\*** Object + appropriate BE + V3 + (by + Subject)

## Common Patterns

| Active      | Passive                 |
|-------------|-------------------------|
| writes      | is/am/are written       |
| wrote       | was/were written        |
| is writing  | is/am/are being written |
| has written | has/have been written   |
| had written | had been written        |
| will write  | will be written         |
| can write   | can be written          |

## Imperative and Modal Examples

Open the door. → **Let the door be opened.**

You must obey the rule. → **The rule must be obeyed.**

### ⚠ Warning

A normal passive transformation requires a suitable transitive construction. Do not force a passive form for every intransitive verb.

## Part O — Direct and Indirect Speech

### Direct Speech

The speaker's exact words are quoted.

He said, "I am tired."

## Indirect Speech

The meaning is reported without quoting the exact words.

He said that he was tired.

## Conversion Checklist

1. Reporting verb
2. Pronouns
3. Tense/backshift where required
4. Time/place expressions
5. Sentence type
6. Connector

## Common Time/Place Changes

| Direct    | Common indirect equivalent |
|-----------|----------------------------|
| now       | then                       |
| today     | that day                   |
| tomorrow  | the next day               |
| yesterday | the previous day           |
| here      | there                      |
| this      | that                       |
| these     | those                      |

## Statements

He said, "I am busy." → He said that he was busy.

## Questions

He said, "Are you ready?" → He asked whether I was ready.

::: trap Indirect questions use **statement word order**:

⊗ He asked where was I going.

✓ He asked where I was going. :::

## Commands / Requests / Advice

The teacher said to me, "Open the book."

The teacher told me to open the book.

The reporting verb should reflect the meaning: **told, ordered, requested, advised, warned**, etc.

## Exclamatory Sentences

The reporting verb may change according to the emotion expressed, such as **exclaimed with joy/sorrow/surprise**.

## Part P — Common Error Detection

| Incorrect                     | Correct                     | Rule                        |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| He do his work.               | He does his work.           | 3rd-person singular         |
| Did he went?                  | Did he go?                  | did + V1                    |
| She is more better.           | She is better.              | no double comparison        |
| He is an university student.  | He is a university student. | sound-based article         |
| I have seen him yesterday.    | I saw him yesterday.        | finished past time          |
| Everyone are ready.           | Everyone is ready.          | singular indefinite pronoun |
| She is good in English.       | She is good at English.     | standard collocation        |
| He discussed about the issue. | He discussed the issue.     | discuss + object            |

### 💡 Exam Tip

For error detection, check: \*\*Subject-Verb → Tense → Article/Determiner → Preposition → Pronoun → Modifier → Word usage\*\*

## Part Q — Confusing Word Pairs

These are common exam-error areas.

| Word       | Meaning/Use       | Example                      |
|------------|-------------------|------------------------------|
| advice     | noun              | He gave me advice.           |
| advise     | verb              | I advise you to study.       |
| affect     | usually verb      | Noise can affect health.     |
| effect     | usually noun      | The effect was clear.        |
| accept     | receive/agree     | He accepted the offer.       |
| except     | excluding         | Everyone came except Ravi.   |
| principal  | head/main         | school principal             |
| principle  | rule/belief       | moral principle              |
| stationery | writing materials | buy stationery               |
| stationary | not moving        | The car remained stationary. |

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## Part R — Hindi Help: Quick Grammar Map

| English     | Short Hindi Help                            |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Noun        | नाम बताने वाला word                         |
| Pronoun     | Noun के स्थान/संदर्भ में आने वाला word      |
| Adjective   | Noun/Pronoun की विशेषता बताता है            |
| Verb        | Action/State बताता है                       |
| Adverb      | Verb/Adjective/Adverb को modify करता है     |
| Preposition | संबंध/स्थान/समय आदि बताता है                |
| Conjunction | words/clauses को जोड़ता है                  |
| Article     | noun के reference को mark करता है           |
| Determiner  | noun को identify/quantify करता है           |
| Tense       | time/aspect की grammatical expression       |
| Voice       | subject/object की grammatical role बताता है |
| Narration   | कही गई बात को report करने का तरीका          |

## Part S — Master Revision Sheet

### 🔑 Remember

- Part of Speech → identify by **\*\*function and context\*\***. - Countable and uncountable nouns behave differently. - Pronouns need a clear, appropriate antecedent. - Comparative/superlative forms should not be doubled. - Modal → **\*\*V1\*\***. - did → **\*\*V1\*\***. - Continuous → **\*\*BE + V-ing\*\***. - Perfect → **\*\*HAVE + V3\*\***. - A/An → **\*\*sound\*\***, not spelling. - Since → starting point; for → duration. - Subject controls subject-verb agreement. - Passive normally requires a suitable transitive construction. - Indirect questions use statement word order. - Few/a few → countable plural; little/a little → uncountable.

## Part T — Practice Set

### Practice

## Section A — Grammar MCQs \*\*1.\*\* Which word is an abstract noun? A. table B. honesty C. teacher D. Delhi \*\*2.\*\* He is \_\_\_ honest man. A. a B. an C. the D. no article \*\*3.\*\* She did not \_\_\_ to school. A. went B. goes C. go D. going \*\*4.\*\* Everyone \_\_\_ ready. A. are B. were C. is D. have \*\*5.\*\* She has lived here \_\_\_ 2020. A. for B. since C. during D. by \*\*6.\*\* Which is correct? A. He can swims. B. He can swim. C. He can swimming. D. He can swam. \*\*7.\*\* Identify the adverb: The child answered quickly. A. child B. answered C. quickly D. the \*\*8.\*\* Which is correct? A. Did she went there? B. Did she goes there? C. Did she go there? D. Did she going there? \*\*9.\*\* The quality of these products \_\_\_ good. A. are B. were C. is D. have \*\*10.\*\* He studies at \_\_\_ university. A. an B. a C. the D. no article \*\*11.\*\* By Friday, she \_\_\_ the work. A. completes B. completed C. will have completed D. has completing \*\*12.\*\* Choose the correct indirect question. A. He asked where was I going. B. He asked where I was going. C. He asked where am I going. D. He asked where I going was. \*\*13.\*\* Which is correct? A. She is more better than me. B. She is better than me. C. She is most better than me. D. She is very better than me. \*\*14.\*\* He cut the paper \_\_\_ a knife. A. by B. with C. from D. at \*\*15.\*\* The teacher praised the student. Choose the passive form. A. The student praised the teacher. B. The student was praised by the teacher. C. The student is praised by the teacher. D. The student had praised the teacher. \*\*16.\*\* Which sentence uses a non-finite form as a noun? A. He is running. B. Running is good exercise. C. He runs daily. D. He ran yesterday. \*\*17.\*\* Choose the correct option: There are \_\_\_ students in the room. A. much B. little C. many D. a little \*\*18.\*\* Choose the correct word: The school \_\_\_ addressed the assembly. A. principal B. principle C. principally D. principled \*\*19.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. He discussed about the problem. B. He discussed the problem. C. He discussed on the problem. D. He discussed for the problem. \*\*20.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. He asked where was she going. B. He asked where she was going. C. He asked where is she going. D. He asked where going she was.

## Answer Key

| Q  | Ans | Key Point                              |
|----|-----|----------------------------------------|
| 1  | B   | Abstract noun                          |
| 2  | B   | vowel sound in honest                  |
| 3  | C   | did + V1                               |
| 4  | C   | everyone → singular verb               |
| 5  | B   | since + starting point                 |
| 6  | B   | modal + V1                             |
| 7  | C   | adverb of manner                       |
| 8  | C   | did + V1                               |
| 9  | C   | subject = quality                      |
| 10 | B   | university begins with consonant sound |
| 11 | C   | future perfect                         |
| 12 | B   | indirect-question word order           |
| 13 | B   | no double comparison                   |
| 14 | B   | instrument → with                      |
| 15 | B   | past simple passive                    |
| 16 | B   | gerund functioning as noun             |
| 17 | C   | many + countable plural noun           |
| 18 | A   | principal = school head                |
| 19 | B   | discuss + object                       |
| 20 | B   | statement word order                   |

### 💡 Exam Tip

**\*\*Practice Method:\*\*** After every wrong answer, return to the relevant rule and solve one fresh example. Detailed notes are meant for understanding, not only memorisation.

## General English — Vocabulary

### PET Detailed Notes | English-first | StudyHub Point

**Scope:** Synonyms • Antonyms • One Word Substitution • Commonly Used Words • Idioms/Phrases  
• Spelling

**Method:** Meaning → Usage → Context → Practice

∴ note **Hindi Help:** English is the primary language. Hindi is used only for difficult meanings, distinctions, or memory support. ∴

## 1. What is Vocabulary?

Vocabulary is the collection of words a learner understands and uses. In competitive exams, vocabulary questions test **meaning, word relationships, correct usage, spelling, and context.**

For PET, a useful vocabulary record contains:

1. Word
2. Meaning
3. Part of speech
4. Synonym
5. Antonym, where useful
6. Example sentence
7. Confusing word, where applicable
8. Correct spelling

### 💡 Exam Tip

Do not memorise a word only as a Hindi translation. Learn it with a short English sentence so you can recognise it in a question or passage.

## 2. Synonyms

A **synonym** is a word with the same or a very similar meaning in a particular context. Exact interchangeability is not guaranteed in every sentence.



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## 2.1 High-Frequency Synonyms — A-C

| Word        | Synonym    | Short Meaning                  |
|-------------|------------|--------------------------------|
| Abandon     | Leave      | give up/leave                  |
| Abolish     | End        | officially end                 |
| Abrupt      | Sudden     | unexpected                     |
| Accurate    | Exact      | correct                        |
| Adequate    | Sufficient | enough                         |
| Adversity   | Hardship   | difficult condition            |
| Alleviate   | Relieve    | make less severe               |
| Ambiguous   | Unclear    | more than one possible meaning |
| Ancient     | Old        | belonging to the distant past  |
| Apparent    | Obvious    | easy to notice                 |
| Arrogant    | Haughty    | overly proud                   |
| Authentic   | Genuine    | real                           |
| Benevolent  | Kind       | well-meaning                   |
| Brief       | Short      | not long                       |
| Brutal      | Cruel      | harsh/violent                  |
| Cautious    | Careful    | avoiding risk                  |
| Cease       | Stop       | come to an end                 |
| Commence    | Begin      | start                          |
| Compel      | Force      | make someone do something      |
| Conceal     | Hide       | keep from view                 |
| Confess     | Admit      | acknowledge wrongdoing/truth   |
| Conspicuous | Noticeable | easy to see                    |

| Word       | Synonym | Short Meaning   |
|------------|---------|-----------------|
| Courageous | Brave   | showing courage |

## 2.2 High-Frequency Synonyms — D-H

| Word      | Synonym     | Short Meaning           |
|-----------|-------------|-------------------------|
| Diligent  | Hardworking | careful and industrious |
| Diminish  | Reduce      | become/make smaller     |
| Diverse   | Varied      | different               |
| Eager     | Keen        | enthusiastic            |
| Eliminate | Remove      | get rid of              |
| Essential | Necessary   | absolutely needed       |
| Evident   | Clear       | easy to see/understand  |
| Fragile   | Delicate    | easily broken           |
| Frequent  | Often       | occurring repeatedly    |
| Genuine   | Authentic   | real                    |
| Generous  | Liberal     | willing to give         |
| Hostile   | Unfriendly  | antagonistic            |
| Humble    | Modest      | not boastful            |

## 2.3 High-Frequency Synonyms — I-P

| Word        | Synonym     | Short Meaning          |
|-------------|-------------|------------------------|
| Inevitable  | Unavoidable | certain to happen      |
| Infer       | Deduce      | conclude from evidence |
| Intelligent | Clever      | mentally capable       |
| Lament      | Mourn       | express sorrow         |
| Mandatory   | Compulsory  | required               |
| Meticulous  | Careful     | very precise/careful   |
| Obsolete    | Outdated    | no longer in use       |
| Obvious     | Evident     | easy to understand     |
| Persuade    | Convince    | cause someone to agree |
| Precise     | Exact       | accurate               |
| Prohibit    | Forbid      | officially prevent     |



## 2.4 High-Frequency Synonyms — R-Z

| Word        | Synonym    | Short Meaning       |
|-------------|------------|---------------------|
| Rapid       | Swift      | very fast           |
| Rare        | Uncommon   | not common          |
| Reluctant   | Unwilling  | not ready/willing   |
| Reliable    | Dependable | can be trusted      |
| Reveal      | Disclose   | make known          |
| Significant | Important  | meaningful          |
| Sufficient  | Enough     | adequate            |
| Temporary   | Short-term | not permanent       |
| Vacant      | Empty      | unoccupied          |
| Vital       | Essential  | extremely important |
| Weary       | Tired      | exhausted           |

### ⚠ Warning

Synonyms are often **\*\*context-dependent\*\***. Two words may be similar in one sentence but not interchangeable in every situation.

## 3. Antonyms

An **antonym** expresses an opposite or contrasting meaning.

### 3.1 High-Frequency Antonym Pairs

| Word       | Antonym   |
|------------|-----------|
| Abundant   | Scarce    |
| Accept     | Reject    |
| Ancient    | Modern    |
| Artificial | Natural   |
| Arrival    | Departure |
| Attractive | Repulsive |
| Bold       | Timid     |
| Broad      | Narrow    |
| Cautious   | Careless  |
| Complex    | Simple    |
| Create     | Destroy   |
| Expand     | Contract  |
| External   | Internal  |
| Failure    | Success   |
| Generous   | Stingy    |
| Guilty     | Innocent  |
| Hope       | Despair   |
| Humble     | Arrogant  |
| Increase   | Decrease  |
| Maximum    | Minimum   |
| Permanent  | Temporary |
| Public     | Private   |

| Word    | Antonym   |
|---------|-----------|
| Rare    | Common    |
| Victory | Defeat    |
| Visible | Invisible |



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## 3.2 More Important Pairs

| Word        | Antonym      |
|-------------|--------------|
| Active      | Passive      |
| Advantage   | Disadvantage |
| Capable     | Incapable    |
| Cheap       | Expensive    |
| Courage     | Cowardice    |
| Domestic    | Foreign      |
| Early       | Late         |
| Flexible    | Rigid        |
| Friend      | Enemy        |
| Include     | Exclude      |
| Liberty     | Slavery      |
| Major       | Minor        |
| Optimist    | Pessimist    |
| Partial     | Complete     |
| Polite      | Rude         |
| Prosperity  | Poverty      |
| Strength    | Weakness     |
| Transparent | Opaque       |

### ⚡ Trick

For an antonym, first identify the **\*\*exact meaning\*\*** of the given word. Then choose the option that directly reverses or contrasts that meaning.

## 4. One Word Substitution

One-word substitution replaces a phrase or description with one suitable English word.



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## 4.1 Persons

| Description                         | One Word       |
|-------------------------------------|----------------|
| One who cannot read or write        | Illiterate     |
| One who loves mankind               | Philanthropist |
| One who hates mankind               | Misanthrope    |
| One who loves books                 | Bibliophile    |
| One who knows many languages        | Polyglot       |
| One who speaks two languages        | Bilingual      |
| One who looks at the bright side    | Optimist       |
| One who expects the worst           | Pessimist      |
| One who cannot be corrected         | Incorrigible   |
| One who travels from place to place | Itinerant      |
| One who eats too much               | Glutton        |
| One who talks too much              | Garrulous      |
| One who is new to an activity       | Novice         |
| One who knows everything            | Omniscient     |
| One who is all-powerful             | Omnipotent     |
| One who is present everywhere       | Omnipresent    |
| One who hates women                 | Misogynist     |
| One who studies mankind             | Anthropologist |
| One who studies plants              | Botanist       |
| One who studies animals             | Zoologist      |
| One who studies stars/space         | Astronomer     |
| One who writes poems                | Poet           |

| Description                 | One Word      |
|-----------------------------|---------------|
| One who writes plays        | Dramatist     |
| One who writes dictionaries | Lexicographer |

## 4.2 Places and Institutions

| Description                               | One Word   |
|-------------------------------------------|------------|
| Place where books are kept                | Library    |
| Place where animals are kept              | Zoo        |
| Place where aircraft are kept             | Hangar     |
| Place where coins are made                | Mint       |
| Place where weapons are stored            | Arsenal    |
| Place where dead bodies are examined/kept | Morgue     |
| Place where soldiers live                 | Barracks   |
| Place where monks live                    | Monastery  |
| Place where nuns live                     | Convent    |
| Place where prisoners are kept            | Prison     |
| Place where experiments are conducted     | Laboratory |
| Place where birds are kept                | Aviary     |
| Place where bees are kept                 | Apiary     |
| Place where ships are repaired/kept       | Dockyard   |

## 4.3 Concepts and Conditions

| Description                       | One Word      |
|-----------------------------------|---------------|
| That which cannot be avoided      | Inevitable    |
| That which cannot be seen         | Invisible     |
| That which cannot be heard        | Inaudible     |
| That which cannot be conquered    | Invincible    |
| That which cannot be cured        | Incurable     |
| That which cannot be believed     | Incredible    |
| That which cannot be read         | Illegible     |
| That which cannot be explained    | Inexplicable  |
| That which can be used only once  | Disposable    |
| A speech made without preparation | Extempore     |
| Life history written by oneself   | Autobiography |
| Life history written by another   | Biography     |
| Government by the people          | Democracy     |
| Government by one person          | Autocracy     |
| Government by a small group       | Oligarchy     |

### Remember

**\*\*Autobiography\*\*** = life story written by oneself. **\*\*Biography\*\*** = life story written by another person.



## 5. Commonly Used Words

| Word        | Meaning              | Example                              |
|-------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Adequate    | enough               | The resources are adequate.          |
| Cautious    | careful              | Be cautious while driving.           |
| Concise     | brief but complete   | Give a concise answer.               |
| Diligent    | hardworking          | She is a diligent student.           |
| Elaborate   | detailed             | He gave an elaborate explanation.    |
| Genuine     | real                 | This is a genuine document.          |
| Hostile     | unfriendly           | The crowd became hostile.            |
| Inevitable  | unavoidable          | Change is inevitable.                |
| Mandatory   | required             | Attendance is mandatory.             |
| Obsolete    | outdated             | The machine is obsolete.             |
| Precise     | exact                | Give a precise answer.               |
| Reluctant   | unwilling            | He was reluctant to speak.           |
| Significant | important            | It was a significant decision.       |
| Sufficient  | enough               | The evidence is sufficient.          |
| Transparent | clear/open           | The process should be transparent.   |
| Vulnerable  | easily harmed        | Some groups are vulnerable.          |
| Ambiguous   | unclear              | The statement is ambiguous.          |
| Adverse     | unfavourable/harmful | The medicine caused adverse effects. |
| Compulsory  | mandatory            | Attendance is compulsory.            |
| Meticulous  | very careful         | She is meticulous in her work.       |

## 6. Idioms and Phrases

An **idiom** is a fixed expression whose overall meaning cannot always be understood by translating each word literally.

### 6.1 Important Idioms — A-M

| Idiom                    | Meaning                                  | Example                                      |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| A blessing in disguise   | apparently bad but ultimately beneficial | The delay was a blessing in disguise.        |
| A piece of cake          | very easy                                | The task was a piece of cake.                |
| At the eleventh hour     | at the last moment                       | He applied at the eleventh hour.             |
| Break the ice            | start a friendly interaction             | The teacher told a joke to break the ice.    |
| Burn the midnight oil    | work/study late at night                 | She burned the midnight oil before the exam. |
| Call it a day            | stop work for the day                    | Let us call it a day.                        |
| Hit the nail on the head | say exactly the right thing              | You hit the nail on the head.                |
| In hot water             | in trouble                               | He is in hot water.                          |
| Once in a blue moon      | very rarely                              | He visits us once in a blue moon.            |
| Spill the beans          | reveal a secret                          | She spilled the beans.                       |
| Under the weather        | feeling unwell                           | I am under the weather today.                |

## 6.2 Important Idioms — N-Z

| Idiom                  | Meaning                   | Example                                           |
|------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| On cloud nine          | extremely happy           | She was on cloud nine.                            |
| See eye to eye         | agree completely          | We do not always see eye to eye.                  |
| Take to task           | scold/criticise           | The manager took him to task.                     |
| The last straw         | final problem in a series | The delay was the last straw.                     |
| Through thick and thin | in good and bad times     | They supported each other through thick and thin. |
| Turn a deaf ear        | refuse to listen          | He turned a deaf ear to the warning.              |
| A storm in a teacup    | fuss about a small matter | It was a storm in a teacup.                       |
| Cost an arm and a leg  | be very expensive         | The car cost an arm and a leg.                    |
| Keep an eye on         | watch carefully           | Keep an eye on the child.                         |
| Make both ends meet    | manage financially        | It is difficult to make both ends meet.           |
| Put off                | postpone                  | They put off the meeting.                         |
| Look down upon         | regard as inferior        | Never look down upon others.                      |
| In the long run        | eventually/over time      | It will help in the long run.                     |
| By leaps and bounds    | very rapidly              | The company is growing by leaps and bounds.       |

### ⚠ Warning

Do not translate idioms word-for-word. Learn **\*\*idiom → meaning → example\*\*** as one unit. **\*\*Hindi Help:\*\*** Idiom का meaning अक्सर literal words से अलग होता है।

## 7. Spelling

Spelling questions may ask you to identify the correctly spelled word or the incorrect spelling.

## 7.1 High-Frequency Spellings

| Correct       | Common Wrong Form |
|---------------|-------------------|
| Accommodation | Accomodation      |
| Beginning     | Begining          |
| Beautiful     | Beautifull        |
| Calendar      | Calender          |
| Committee     | Commitee          |
| Definitely    | Definately        |
| Environment   | Enviroment        |
| Government    | Goverment         |
| Independent   | Independant       |
| Necessary     | Necesary          |
| Occurrence    | Occurence         |
| Privilege     | Priviledge        |
| Pronunciation | Pronounciation    |
| Receive       | Recieve           |
| Separate      | Seperate          |
| Successful    | Succesful         |
| Tomorrow      | Tommorow          |
| Maintenance   | Maintainance      |
| Questionnaire | Questionaire      |
| Embarrass     | Embarass          |
| Existence     | Existance         |
| Knowledge     | Knowlege          |

| Correct    | Common Wrong Form |
|------------|-------------------|
| Liaison    | Liason            |
| Millennium | Millenium         |
| Restaurant | Restuarant        |
| Rhythm     | Rythm             |

## 7.2 Spelling Clues

Pay special attention to:

- double consonants
- vowel order
- silent letters
- common suffixes
- repeated letters

### ⚡ Trick

When options look similar, compare them letter-by-letter. Do not rely only on how the word sounds.

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## 8. Homophones and Confusing Words

| Word 1     | Word 2     | Difference                                    |
|------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| accept     | except     | receive/agree vs excluding                    |
| advice     | advise     | noun vs verb                                  |
| affect     | effect     | usually verb vs usually noun                  |
| principal  | principle  | head/main vs rule/belief                      |
| stationery | stationary | writing materials vs not moving               |
| complement | compliment | completes vs praise                           |
| loose      | lose       | not tight vs fail to keep                     |
| later      | latter     | afterwards vs second of two                   |
| beside     | besides    | next to vs in addition                        |
| personal   | personnel  | individual/private vs staff                   |
| adapt      | adopt      | adjust vs take up/accept                      |
| assure     | ensure     | tell confidently vs make certain              |
| allusion   | illusion   | indirect reference vs false appearance        |
| moral      | morale     | principle of right/wrong vs confidence/spirit |
| practice   | practise   | noun vs verb in British usage                 |
| conscience | conscious  | moral sense vs aware                          |
| desert     | dessert    | dry region/abandon vs sweet course            |

### Example

**\*\*Advice / Advise\*\*** - He gave me useful **\*\*advice\*\***. → noun - I **\*\*advise\*\*** you to study. → verb  
**\*\*Principal / Principle\*\*** - The school **\*\*principal\*\*** addressed the students. - Honesty is an important **\*\*principle\*\***.

## 9. Word Formation

Prefixes and suffixes can help you infer meaning and grammatical category.

### 9.1 Common Prefixes

| Prefix | General idea     | Example       |
|--------|------------------|---------------|
| un-    | not/reversal     | unhappy       |
| dis-   | opposite/absence | dishonest     |
| re-    | again            | rewrite       |
| mis-   | wrongly          | misunderstand |
| pre-   | before           | preview       |
| post-  | after            | postgraduate  |
| anti-  | against          | antiwar       |
| inter- | between          | international |
| intra- | within           | intrastate    |
| sub-   | under/below      | submarine     |
| super- | above/beyond     | supernatural  |
| trans- | across           | transport     |

## 9.2 Common Suffixes

| Suffix      | Common role     | Example             |
|-------------|-----------------|---------------------|
| -ness       | noun            | kindness            |
| -ment       | noun            | development         |
| -tion/-sion | noun            | education, decision |
| -ity        | noun            | ability             |
| -er/-or     | person/agent    | teacher, actor      |
| -ful        | adjective       | useful              |
| -less       | adjective       | careless            |
| -able/-ible | adjective       | readable, visible   |
| -ly         | commonly adverb | quickly             |

### Exam Tip

Prefixes and suffixes are clues, not guaranteed formulas. Confirm the meaning from context.

## 10. Vocabulary in Context

When an unfamiliar word appears in a sentence or passage, use context clues.

### Definition Clue

The sentence directly explains the word.

### Contrast Clue

Words such as **but**, **however**, **unlike**, **although** may signal contrast.



## Example Clue

Examples around the word may reveal its meaning.

## Restatement Clue

A later phrase may express the same idea in simpler language.

::: strategy **Context-solving method:**

1. Read the whole sentence.
2. Identify the likely part of speech.
3. Read before and after the word.
4. Look for definition, contrast, example, or restatement.
5. Substitute each option mentally.
6. Select the option that fits the complete context. :::

# 11. Vocabulary by Part of Speech

Learning related forms helps with sentence-based questions.

| Noun       | Verb     | Adjective        | Adverb               |
|------------|----------|------------------|----------------------|
| success    | succeed  | successful       | successfully         |
| beauty     | beautify | beautiful        | beautifully          |
| decision   | decide   | decisive         | decisively           |
| difference | differ   | different        | differently          |
| importance | —        | important        | importantly          |
| care       | care     | careful/careless | carefully/carelessly |
| confidence | —        | confident        | confidently          |
| patience   | —        | patient          | patiently            |

::: note Not every word has a common form in all four columns. Learn natural usage rather than forcing a word into every category. :::

## 12. High-Frequency Vocabulary Bank

### A-E

- Abandon — leave/give up
- Abolish — officially end
- Abundant — plentiful
- Accurate — exact/correct
- Adequate — sufficient
- Adverse — harmful/unfavourable
- Ambiguous — unclear
- Apparent — obvious
- Authentic — genuine
- Benevolent — kind
- Cautious — careful
- Cease — stop
- Compel — force
- Conceal — hide
- Concise — brief but complete
- Diligent — hardworking
- Diminish — reduce
- Diverse — varied
- Eager — keen
- Eliminate — remove
- Essential — necessary

### F-P

- Fragile — easily broken
- Frequent — occurring often
- Genuine — real

- Hostile — unfriendly
- Humble — modest
- Inevitable — unavoidable
- Infer — deduce
- Mandatory — compulsory
- Meticulous — very careful
- Obsolete — outdated
- Obvious — clear
- Persuade — convince
- Precise — exact
- Prohibit — forbid

## R-Z

- Rapid — swift
- Rare — uncommon
- Reluctant — unwilling
- Reliable — dependable
- Reveal — disclose
- Significant — important
- Sufficient — enough
- Temporary — short-term
- Vacant — empty
- Vital — essential
- Weary — tired



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## 13. Exam Vocabulary Strategy

### Before the Exam

- Learn 15-20 useful words regularly.
- Revise old words before adding new ones.
- Maintain synonym and antonym pairs.
- Learn one sentence for difficult words.

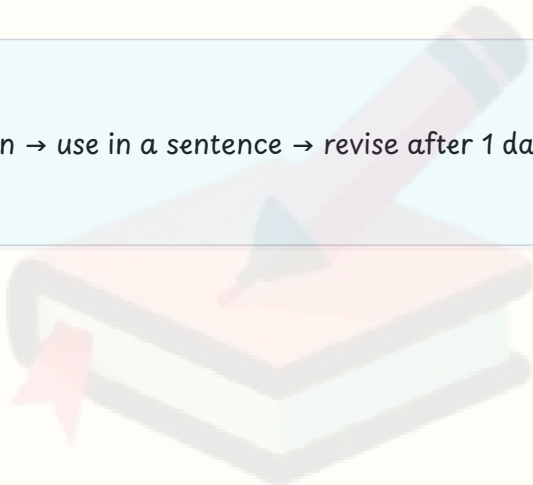
- Maintain a spelling-error list.
- Group confusing words together.

## During the Exam

1. Read the complete question.
2. Identify whether it asks synonym, antonym, usage, spelling, or substitution.
3. Eliminate clearly unrelated options.
4. Use context whenever available.
5. Do not spend excessive time on one unfamiliar word.

### Exam Tip

**\*\*Best revision cycle:\*\*** Learn → use in a sentence → revise after 1 day → revise after 1 week → test yourself.



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## 14. Practice Set — Vocabulary

### Practice

**\*\*1.\*\*** Choose the synonym of **\*\*Abandon\*\***. A. Keep B. Leave C. Build D. Protect **\*\*2.\*\*** Choose the antonym of **\*\*Ancient\*\***. A. Old B. Historic C. Modern D. Former **\*\*3.\*\*** One who loves books is called a: A. Bibliophile B. Misanthrope C. Polyglot D. Optimist **\*\*4.\*\*** One who knows many languages is a: A. Novice B. Polyglot C. Illiterate D. Glutton **\*\*5.\*\*** One who cannot read or write is: A. Literate B. Illiterate C. Omniscient D. Itinerant **\*\*6.\*\*** “At the eleventh hour” means: A. Very early B. At the last moment C. Every hour D. For eleven hours **\*\*7.\*\*** “Break the ice” means: A. Create a problem B. Start a friendly interaction C. End a meeting D. Break something **\*\*8.\*\*** Choose the correct spelling. A. Seperate B. Separate C. Seprate D. Separete **\*\*9.\*\*** Choose the correct spelling. A. Accomodation B. Accommodation C. Acommodation D. Accommadation **\*\*10.\*\*** He gave me useful \_\_\_\_\_. A. advices B. advice C. advise D. advises **\*\*11.\*\*** Everyone came \_\_\_\_\_ Ravi. A. accept B. advice C. except D. affect **\*\*12.\*\*** Choose the antonym of **\*\*Expand\*\***. A. Increase B. Extend C. Contract D. Enlarge **\*\*13.\*\*** Choose the synonym of **\*\*Reluctant\*\***. A. Unwilling B. Eager C. Certain D. Generous **\*\*14.\*\*** The school \_\_\_\_\_ addressed the assembly. A. principle B. principal C. principally D. principled **\*\*15.\*\*** The car remained \_\_\_\_\_. A. stationery B. stationary C. stationarity D. stationed **\*\*16.\*\*** “Under the weather” means: A. Outdoors B. Feeling unwell C. Travelling D. Feeling excited **\*\*17.\*\*** One who loves mankind is a: A. Misanthrope B. Philanthropist C. Misogynist D. Pessimist **\*\*18.\*\*** One who cannot be conquered is: A. Invisible B. Incurable C. Invincible D. Inaudible **\*\*19.\*\*** Choose the antonym of **\*\*Permanent\*\***. A. Stable B. Fixed C. Temporary D. Lasting **\*\*20.\*\*** Choose the synonym of **\*\*Precise\*\***. A. Exact B. Rough C. Vague D. Careless **\*\*21.\*\*** “Spill the beans” means: A. Waste food B. Reveal a secret C. Make a mistake D. Work hard **\*\*22.\*\*** Noise can \_\_\_\_\_ concentration. A. effect B. affect C. except D. accept **\*\*23.\*\*** The \_\_\_\_\_ of the decision was significant. A. affect B. effect C. advice D. advise **\*\*24.\*\*** Choose the antonym of **\*\*Generous\*\***. A. Kind B. Stingy C. Helpful D. Noble **\*\*25.\*\*** A life history written by oneself is called: A. Biography B. Autobiography C. Bibliography D. Geography **\*\*26.\*\*** A government by the people is: A. Autocracy B. Oligarchy C. Democracy D. Monarchy **\*\*27.\*\*** Choose the correct spelling. A. Definately B. Definitly C. Definitely D. Definetely **\*\*28.\*\*** Choose the synonym of **\*\*Obsolete\*\***. A. Modern B. Outdated C. Current D. New **\*\*29.\*\*** Honesty is an important \_\_\_\_\_. A. principal B. principle C. principally D. principalise **\*\*30.\*\*** “Make both ends meet” means: A. Join two objects B. Manage financially C. Finish early D. Travel widely **\*\*31.\*\*** Choose the antonym of **\*\*Visible\*\***. A. Clear B. Obvious C. Invisible D. Apparent **\*\*32.\*\*** Choose the synonym of **\*\*Diligent\*\***. A. Lazy B. Hardworking C. Careless D. Weak **\*\*33.\*\*** A person new to a profession or activity is a: A. Veteran B. Novice C. Expert D. Master **\*\*34.\*\*** “Hit the nail on the head” means: A. Work with tools B. Say exactly the right thing C. Make a mistake D. Avoid a problem **\*\*35.\*\*** Choose the correct spelling. A. Pronounciation B. Pronunciation C. Pronuncation D. Pronounciaton **\*\*36.\*\*** Please \_\_\_\_\_ that the door is locked. A. assure B. ensure C. insure D. assurance **\*\*37.\*\*** The

tie \_\_\_ the shirt. A. compliments B. complements C. compliments D. complementing \*\*38.\*\*  
 Choose the antonym of **Hostile**. A. Friendly B. Angry C. Violent D. Unfriendly \*\*39.\*\* "Once in a blue moon" means: A. Very often B. Very rarely C. Every month D. At night \*\*40.\*\* Choose the synonym of **Inevitable**. A. Avoidable B. Unavoidable C. Unlikely D. Optional \*\*41.\*\* Choose the correct spelling. A. Enviroment B. Envirnoment C. Environment D. Environmant \*\*42.\*\* One who writes dictionaries is a: A. Biographer B. Lexicographer C. Calligrapher D. Photographer \*\*43.\*\* Choose the antonym of **Maximum**. A. Minimum B. Major C. Large D. Highest \*\*44.\*\* "Put off" means: A. Wear B. Postpone C. Remove permanently D. Encourage \*\*45.\*\* The two sides reached a \_\_\_\_\_. A. consensus B. conscious C. conscience D. consenting \*\*46.\*\* Choose the synonym of **Reveal**. A. Conceal B. Disclose C. Hide D. Cover \*\*47.\*\* Choose the antonym of **Scarce**. A. Rare B. Abundant C. Limited D. Insufficient \*\*48.\*\* Choose the correct spelling. A. Occurence B. Occurrence C. Ocurrance D. Occurance \*\*49.\*\* "In the long run" means: A. Immediately B. Eventually/over a long period C. Randomly D. Never \*\*50.\*\* He gave me a sincere \_\_\_\_\_. A. compliment B. complement C. complementary D. complimenting



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## 15. Answer Key

| Q  | Ans | Key Point                  |
|----|-----|----------------------------|
| 1  | B   | abandon = leave            |
| 2  | C   | ancient ↔ modern           |
| 3  | A   | bibliophile                |
| 4  | B   | polyglot                   |
| 5  | B   | illiterate                 |
| 6  | B   | last moment                |
| 7  | B   | start friendly interaction |
| 8  | B   | separate                   |
| 9  | B   | accommodation              |
| 10 | B   | advice = noun              |
| 11 | C   | except = excluding         |
| 12 | C   | expand ↔ contract          |
| 13 | A   | reluctant = unwilling      |
| 14 | B   | principal = school head    |
| 15 | B   | stationary = not moving    |
| 16 | B   | feeling unwell             |
| 17 | B   | philanthropist             |
| 18 | C   | invincible                 |
| 19 | C   | permanent ↔ temporary      |
| 20 | A   | precise = exact            |
| 21 | B   | reveal a secret            |

| Q  | Ans | Key Point                             |
|----|-----|---------------------------------------|
| 22 | B   | affect = usually verb                 |
| 23 | B   | effect = usually noun                 |
| 24 | B   | generous ↔ stingy                     |
| 25 | B   | autobiography                         |
| 26 | C   | democracy                             |
| 27 | C   | definitely                            |
| 28 | B   | obsolete = outdated                   |
| 29 | B   | principle = rule/belief               |
| 30 | B   | manage financially                    |
| 31 | C   | visible ↔ invisible                   |
| 32 | B   | diligent = hardworking                |
| 33 | B   | novice                                |
| 34 | B   | exactly right                         |
| 35 | B   | pronunciation                         |
| 36 | B   | ensure = make certain                 |
| 37 | B   | complement = completes/goes well with |
| 38 | A   | hostile ↔ friendly                    |
| 39 | B   | very rarely                           |
| 40 | B   | inevitable = unavoidable              |
| 41 | C   | environment                           |
| 42 | B   | lexicographer                         |
| 43 | A   | maximum ↔ minimum                     |
| 44 | B   | put off = postpone                    |
| 45 | A   | consensus = general agreement         |



| Q  | Ans | Key Point            |
|----|-----|----------------------|
| 46 | B   | reveal = disclose    |
| 47 | B   | scarce ↔ abundant    |
| 48 | B   | occurrence           |
| 49 | B   | eventually/over time |
| 50 | A   | compliment = praise  |

### 🔑 Remember

**\*\*PET Vocabulary Formula:\*\*** \*\*Word → Meaning → Part of Speech → Synonym/Antonym → Usage → Confusing Pair → Revision → Practice\*\* This is the standard to follow for the remaining PET English notes.

## General English — Sentence Ability

### PET Detailed Notes | English-first | StudyHub Point

**Focus:** Sentence Correction → Sentence Improvement → Fill in the Blanks → Error Detection → Sentence Arrangement

**Hindi Help:** Only for difficult grammar logic or confusing exam patterns.

## 1. What is Sentence Ability?

Sentence ability means understanding whether a sentence is **grammatically correct, logically complete, properly ordered, and appropriate in context**.

For PET, sentence ability is built from grammar, vocabulary, collocation, context, and logical sequencing.

### 💡 Exam Tip

**\*\*Exam Tip:\*\*** Never change a sentence simply because it sounds unusual. Identify the exact grammar, usage, or logic rule first.

## 2. Sentence Structure Basics

A basic sentence can be represented as:

**Subject + Verb + Object / Complement**

*Ravi reads books.*

- **Subject:** the person/thing about which the sentence is made.
- **Verb:** action, occurrence, or state.
- **Object:** receives the action.
- **Complement:** completes the meaning of the subject/object.

### 2.1 Phrase vs Clause

**Phrase:** a group of words functioning as a unit, normally without a finite verb.

*in the morning*

**Clause:** a group of words containing a subject-verb relationship.

*when he arrived*

### 2.2 Sentence Types by Structure

#### Simple Sentence

One independent clause.

*She works hard.*

#### Compound Sentence

Two or more independent clauses joined appropriately.

She works hard, and she studies regularly.

## Complex Sentence

One independent clause and one or more subordinate clauses.

She studies hard because she wants to succeed.

### Core Concept

Sentence structure is the foundation of **correction, improvement, error detection, and arrangement** questions.

## 3. Sentence Correction

Sentence correction asks you to identify an incorrect form and replace it with the grammatically or contextually correct form.

### 3.1 Correction Checklist

Check in this order:

1. Subject-Verb Agreement
2. Tense and verb form
3. Pronoun
4. Article / Determiner
5. Preposition
6. Adjective / Adverb
7. Conjunction
8. Word order
9. Parallel structure
10. Meaning and logical fit
11. Collocation / idiomatic usage

∴ strategy **Locate** → **Identify the rule** → **Correct** → **Re-read the complete sentence.**

Change only what is necessary. ∴

## 4. Subject-Verb Errors

A singular subject generally takes a singular verb in the present simple; a plural subject generally takes a plural verb.

- ⊗ He **go** to school.
- ✓ He **goes** to school.
- ⊗ The students **is** ready.
- ✓ The students **are** ready.

### Intervening Phrases

- ⊗ The quality of these products **are** good.
- ✓ The quality of these products **is** good.

The subject is **quality**, not products.

∴ trap Do not select the verb according to the nearest noun. Find the grammatical subject first. ∴

## 5. Tense and Verb-Form Errors

### After Do / Does / Did

Use V1.

- ⊗ Did he **went** there?
- ✓ Did he **go** there?
- ⊗ She does not **likes** tea.
- ✓ She does not **like** tea.

### After Modals

Use V1.

- ⊗ He can **swims**.
- ✓ He can **swim**.

## Perfect Forms

Use **have/has/had + V3**.

- ⊗ She has **went** home.
- ✓ She has **gone** home.

### Remember

**\*\*did + V1\*\*   \*\*modal + V1\*\*   \*\*have/has/had + V3\*\***

## 6. Pronoun Errors

A pronoun should clearly and appropriately refer to its antecedent.

- ⊗ Riya told Priya that **she** had won.

This may be ambiguous without context.

### Pronoun Case

After a preposition, use the appropriate object form in formal standard usage:

- ⊗ Between you and **I**
- ✓ Between you and **me**

### Exam Tip

Always identify the antecedent before selecting a pronoun.

## 7. Article and Determiner Errors

### A / An

Choose according to sound.

- ⊗ an university
- ✓ a university

⊗ a hour

✓ an hour

## Much / Many

- **many** + countable plural noun
- **much** + uncountable noun

⊗ much students

✓ many students

## Few / A Few / Little / A Little

- few → almost none; countable plural
- a few → some; countable plural
- little → almost none; uncountable
- a little → some; uncountable

∴ trap The article can change the meaning: **few** and **a few** are not equivalent. ∴

## 8. Preposition Errors

Common combinations:

- good **at** English
- interested **in** music
- depend **on** someone
- consist **of** parts
- listen **to** music
- responsible **for** the work
- afraid **of** dogs
- different **from** another

⊗ He discussed **about** the issue.

✓ He discussed the issue.

### ⚠ Warning

Learn prepositions with the word they normally accompany. Direct translation from Hindi often creates errors.

## 9. Adjective and Adverb Errors

**Adjective:** modifies a noun/pronoun.

She is a **careful** driver.

**Adverb:** modifies a verb, adjective, adverb, or clause.

She drives **carefully**.

After linking verbs such as **be, seem, look, feel, become**, an adjective is often used to describe the subject.

She looks **beautiful**.

∴ trap Do not automatically add **-ly** to make an adverb. Word function and meaning matter. ∴

## 10. Comparison Errors

### Comparative

Ravi is **taller than** Mohan.

### Superlative

Ravi is **the tallest** boy in the class.

Avoid double comparison:

- ⊗ more better
- ⊗ most tallest
- ✓ better
- ✓ tallest

Common irregular forms:

- good → better → best
- bad → worse → worst
- little → less → least
- many/much → more → most

## 11. Conjunction Errors

Common correlative pairs:

- either...or
- neither...nor
- both...and
- not only...but also
- whether...or

She is **not only intelligent but also hardworking**.

### ⚠ Warning

Maintain parallel grammatical structures after paired conjunctions.

## 12. Parallelism

Parallelism means using the same grammatical form for items in a series or comparison.

- ⊗ She likes **reading, to write, and dancing**.
- ✓ She likes **reading, writing, and dancing**.

Other examples:



⊗ He wanted to **study, working, and to travel**.

✓ He wanted to **study, work, and travel**.

### Core Concept

When several items are joined by **\*\*and/or\*\***, check whether they perform the same grammatical role.

## 13. Modifiers and Word Order

A modifier should be positioned so that its intended meaning is clear.

### Basic Word Order

**Subject → Verb → Object**

The student solved the problem.

### Misplaced Modifier

She almost finished all the work.

The position of **almost** affects what is being limited.

### 💡 Exam Tip

English generally depends more strongly on word order than Hindi. Avoid direct word-for-word translation.

## 14. Sentence Improvement

Sentence improvement questions present a sentence with an underlined or highlighted part. You must select the option that gives the **best grammatical and contextual form**.

## 14.1 Improvement Strategy

1. Read the complete sentence.
2. Identify the faulty portion.
3. Determine the rule involved.
4. Check whether the original may already be correct.
5. Compare the alternatives.
6. Choose the most natural and precise form.

∴ strategy **Do not improve only grammar.** Check grammar + meaning + tense + collocation + logical consistency. ∴

## 14.2 Common Improvement Areas

- subject-verb agreement
- tense
- articles
- prepositions
- pronouns
- comparison
- parallelism
- word choice
- collocation
- redundancy

### Examples

1. He is senior **than** me.  
→ He is senior **to** me.
2. She returned **back** home.  
→ She returned home.
3. He discussed **about** the issue.  
→ He discussed the issue.
4. She is **more better** than her sister.  
→ She is better than her sister.

### **Warning**

Some improvement questions contain an option such as **“No improvement”**. Do not change a correct sentence unnecessarily.

## 15. Redundancy

Redundancy occurs when unnecessary words repeat the same meaning.

Common examples:

- return back → return
- repeat again → repeat
- discuss about → discuss
- enter into the room → enter the room (when “enter” means go into)
- revert back → revert

∴ trap Not every repeated-looking phrase is automatically wrong; judge the actual construction and meaning. ∴

## 16. Fill in the Blanks

Fill-in-the-blank questions can test grammar, vocabulary, collocation, and context.

### **Step-by-Step Method**

1. Read the entire sentence.
2. Predict the required part of speech.
3. Check grammar.
4. Check meaning.
5. Check collocation.
6. Insert the best option.
7. Re-read the full sentence.

## Grammar Clues

He is \_\_\_ honest man. → **an**

She is good \_\_\_ English. → **at**

Everyone \_\_\_ ready. → **is**

She has \_\_\_ the work. → **completed**

## Context Clue

The instructions were very \_\_\_, so everyone understood them.

The answer should express **clarity**, not simply fit grammatically.

# 17. Cloze-Style Context Fillers

A cloze passage contains several blanks. Each blank must be solved using the **local grammar and the overall meaning of the passage**.

## Cloze Strategy

1. Read the complete passage once.
2. Identify the topic and tone.
3. Predict the missing word.
4. Check grammar around the blank.
5. Check the meaning of the whole sentence.
6. Re-read the passage after filling all blanks.

::: strategy Do not solve every cloze blank independently. Later sentences can provide clues for earlier blanks. :::

## 18. Collocations

A collocation is a combination of words that commonly occur together.

Examples:

- **make** a decision
- **do** homework
- **take** a break
- **pay** attention
- **catch** a bus
- **heavy** rain
- **strong** tea
- **deep** sleep
- **commit** a crime
- **keep** a promise

### ⚠ Warning

A grammatically possible word is not always the natural word. Collocation can determine the correct answer.

## 19. Error Detection

In error-detection questions, a sentence may be divided into parts.

He / do / his work / regularly.

Error → **do**

Correction → **does**

### Error Detection Order

**Subject-Verb → Tense → Pronoun → Article/Determiner → Preposition → Modifier → Parallelism → Vocabulary/Collocation**

### ⚡ Trick

For a long sentence, first locate the **\*\*main subject + main verb + object/complement\*\***. Then inspect the likely error zones.

## 20. Mixed Grammar Errors

A sentence may contain more than one possible-looking problem. Identify the error that actually violates standard grammar or the intended meaning.

Example:

The students of this class **is** preparing for the test.

Main error → **is**

Correction → **are**

The phrase **of this class** does not change the plural subject **students**.

## 21. Sentence Arrangement

Sentence arrangement requires you to put sentences or parts into a logical sequence.

### 21.1 Opening Sentence

A likely opening sentence often:

- introduces the topic
- introduces the person/thing
- gives the general background
- does not depend on an earlier reference

A sentence beginning with **he, she, this, that, these, such, therefore** is often unlikely to be the first sentence if its reference has not yet been introduced.

## 21.2 Pronoun Link

Ravi entered the room. **He** sat down.

The sentence introducing Ravi normally precedes the sentence beginning with **he**.

## 21.3 Demonstrative Link

Words such as **this, that, these, those, such** often refer to an earlier idea or noun.

## 21.4 Connector Link

- however → contrast
- therefore → result
- moreover → addition
- consequently → result
- finally → concluding stage

### ⚡ Trick

Look for **\*\*mandatory pairs\*\*** before trying every possible order. If one sentence clearly explains "this", find the sentence that introduces the relevant idea.

## 22. Chronological Order

When events occur over time, use the sequence:

**first → then → next → after that → finally**

Other clues include dates, ages, stages, and time expressions.

## 23. Cause and Effect

Common pattern:

## Cause → Result

It rained heavily. **Therefore**, the match was cancelled.

### Result markers

therefore, hence, thus, consequently, as a result

### Cause markers

because, since, as, due to, owing to

#### 💡 Exam Tip

A result marker normally connects an effect to an earlier cause or explanation.

## 24. Contrast and Continuation

### Contrast

however, but, although, nevertheless, whereas, yet

### Addition

moreover, furthermore, also, in addition, besides

⚠️ trap **However** normally signals a contrast with a preceding idea. Do not automatically make it the first sentence of a paragraph. ⚠️

## 25. Advanced Sentence Arrangement Technique

Use a **link-chain** approach:

**Opening → Noun introduction → Pronoun/reference → Explanation → Result/example → Conclusion**



## Strong clues

1. Full name → pronoun
2. General statement → specific example
3. Cause → effect
4. Question → answer/explanation
5. Problem → solution
6. First event → later event
7. Claim → evidence

∴ strategy If options are given as sequences, find a strong pair first. Once one pair is fixed, eliminate sequences that break that pair. ∴

## 26. Question Formation

Correct question structure is useful in sentence correction and transformation.

### Yes/No Questions

**Auxiliary + Subject + Main Verb...?**

Does he work here?

### WH Questions

**WH-word + Auxiliary + Subject + Main Verb...?**

Where does he live?

∴ trap After an auxiliary such as **do/does/did**, use V1:

- ⊗ Where did he went?
- Ⓢ Where did he go? ∴

## 27. Negative Sentence Formation

Common patterns:

- Present simple → do/does not + V1
- Past simple → did not + V1
- Be verb → be + not
- Modal → modal + not + V1
- Perfect → have/has/had + not + V3

Examples:

He does not work here.

She did not go.

He cannot swim.

They have not finished.

## 28. Punctuation Basics for Sentence Ability

Basic punctuation can affect sentence clarity.

### Full Stop

Ends a statement.

### Comma

Separates items, introductory elements, or clauses in appropriate constructions.

### Apostrophe

Shows possession or contraction.

- Ravi's book
- don't = do not

## Question Mark

Used after a direct question.

Where are you going?

## Quotation Marks

Used for direct speech in standard English writing.

### ⚠ Warning

Do not confuse an apostrophe for possession with a plural marker: **\*\*book's\*\*** does not normally mean “books”.

# 29. Common Sentence Ability Traps

::: trap

## Trap 1 — Nearest noun

The nearest noun is not necessarily the subject.

## Trap 2 — Direct translation

Hindi sentence order does not always map directly to English.

## Trap 3 — Familiar option

A familiar word may still be grammatically or contextually wrong.

## Trap 4 — Connector without reference

However, therefore, this, that, and such often depend on earlier context.

## Trap 5 — Pronoun before antecedent

A pronoun may be unclear when its reference has not been established.

### Trap 6 — Double comparison

more better / most tallest.

### Trap 7 — Redundancy

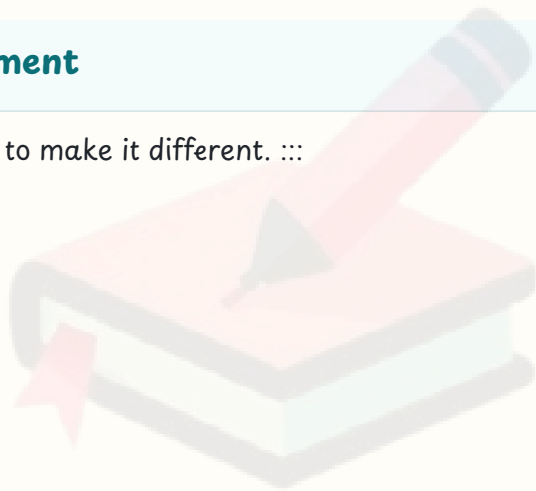
return back / repeat again / discuss about.

### Trap 8 — Collocation

A word can be grammatically possible but unnatural with the surrounding words.

### Trap 9 — No improvement

Do not alter a sentence merely to make it different. ∴



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## 30. Quick Correction Bank

| Incorrect                  | Correct                   | Rule             |
|----------------------------|---------------------------|------------------|
| He do his work.            | He does his work.         | agreement        |
| Did she went?              | Did she go?               | did + V1         |
| He can sings.              | He can sing.              | modal + V1       |
| She has went home.         | She has gone home.        | perfect + V3     |
| an university              | a university              | sound            |
| a hour                     | an hour                   | sound            |
| much students              | many students             | countability     |
| He discussed about it.     | He discussed it.          | discuss + object |
| Between you and I          | Between you and me        | object form      |
| more better                | better                    | comparison       |
| most tallest               | tallest                   | comparison       |
| reading, to write, dancing | reading, writing, dancing | parallelism      |
| He is senior than me.      | He is senior to me.       | usage            |
| return back                | return                    | redundancy       |
| repeat again               | repeat                    | redundancy       |

## 31. Hindi Help — Fast Identification

| Task        | Ask yourself                                              |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Subject     | Who/what controls the verb?                               |
| Object      | Who/what receives the action?                             |
| Tense       | When/how is the action expressed?                         |
| Article     | General or specific? What sound follows?                  |
| Preposition | Which fixed combination is required?                      |
| Improvement | Is the alternative grammatically and contextually better? |
| Error       | Which exact rule is broken?                               |
| Arrangement | Which sentence introduces and which sentence refers?      |
| Connector   | Cause, result, contrast, or addition?                     |

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## 32. Practice Set — Sentence Ability

### Practice

## Section A — Correction \*\*1.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. He do his work daily. B. He does his work daily. C. He doing his work daily. D. He did his work daily every day. \*\*2.\*\* Did she \_\_\_ the letter? A. wrote B. writes C. write D. writing \*\*3.\*\* Everyone \_\_\_ present. A. are B. were C. is D. have \*\*4.\*\* He is good \_\_\_ English. A. in B. at C. on D. by \*\*5.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. She is more better than me. B. She is better than me. C. She is most better than me. D. She is very better than me. \*\*6.\*\* Choose the correct article: He is \_\_\_ honest man. A. a B. an C. the D. no article \*\*7.\*\* Choose the correct form: She has \_\_\_ home. A. went B. go C. gone D. going \*\*8.\*\* Choose the parallel sentence. A. She likes reading, to write and dancing. B. She likes reading, writing and dancing. C. She likes to reading, writing and dance. D. She likes read, writing and dancing. \*\*9.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. He discussed about the problem. B. He discussed the problem. C. He discussed on the problem. D. He discussed for the problem. \*\*10.\*\* The quality of these products \_\_\_ good. A. are B. were C. is D. have ## Section B — Sentence Improvement \*\*11.\*\* He is senior \_\_\_ me. A. than B. to C. from D. with \*\*12.\*\* She returned \_\_\_ home. A. back B. again C. to back D. no additional word \*\*13.\*\* Choose the best form: He discussed \_\_\_ the issue. A. about B. on C. for D. no preposition \*\*14.\*\* Choose the best sentence. A. She is more better now. B. She is better now. C. She is most better now. D. She is very better now. \*\*15.\*\* Choose the correct form: He wanted to study, \_\_\_, and travel. A. working B. worked C. work D. to working ## Section C — Fill in the Blanks \*\*16.\*\* She has lived here \_\_\_ 2020. A. for B. since C. during D. by \*\*17.\*\* There are \_\_\_ students in the room. A. much B. many C. little D. a little \*\*18.\*\* The instructions were very \_\_\_, so everyone understood them. A. clear B. careless C. hostile D. reluctant \*\*19.\*\* He \_\_\_ a decision after careful thought. A. did B. made C. paid D. took up \*\*20.\*\* She is \_\_\_ honest person. A. a B. an C. the D. no article ## Section D — Arrangement \*\*21.\*\* Arrange the sentences: A. He opened the book. B. Ravi sat at his desk. C. He began to read. A. A-B-C B. B-A-C C. C-A-B D. B-C-A \*\*22.\*\* Which is usually the best opening sentence? A. This surprised everyone. B. He then entered the room. C. Ravi entered the room. D. Therefore, they left. \*\*23.\*\* Which connector normally signals a result? A. However B. Although C. Therefore D. But \*\*24.\*\* Which connector most clearly signals contrast? A. therefore B. however C. consequently D. hence \*\*25.\*\* In an arrangement, which usually comes first? A. He, when the person has not been introduced B. This, when the idea has not been introduced C. The sentence introducing the main topic D. Therefore, without a previous cause ## Section E — Mixed Ability \*\*26.\*\* Choose the correct question. A. Where did he went? B. Where did he go? C. Where he did go? D. Where did he going? \*\*27.\*\* Choose the correct negative sentence. A. She did not went. B. She did not goes. C. She did not go. D. She not did go. \*\*28.\*\* Identify the error: "The quality of these products are excellent." A. quality B. these C. are D. excellent \*\*29.\*\* Choose the correct collocation. A. do a decision B. make a decision C. pay a decision D. give a decision \*\*30.\*\* Choose the correct indirect-question form. A. He asked

where was I going. B. He asked where I was going. C. He asked where am I going. D. He asked where going I was. \*\*31.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. Between you and I, this is true. B. Between you and me, this is true. C. Between you and myself, this is true. D. Between you and mine, this is true. \*\*32.\*\* Choose the correct article. A. a hour B. an hour C. the hour always D. an university \*\*33.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. She looks beautifully. B. She looks beautiful. C. She looks beauty. D. She looks beautify. \*\*34.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. He can swims well. B. He can swim well. C. He can swimming well. D. He can swam well. \*\*35.\*\* Choose the best correction: "He returned back yesterday." A. He returned yesterday. B. He returned back again yesterday. C. He did returned yesterday. D. He returning yesterday. \*\*36.\*\* Choose the sentence with correct parallelism. A. She likes reading, to write and dancing. B. She likes reading, writing and dancing. C. She likes read, writing and dance. D. She likes to reading, writing and dancing. \*\*37.\*\* Choose the best connector: "It was raining heavily; \_\_\_\_, the match was cancelled." A. however B. therefore C. although D. meanwhile \*\*38.\*\* Choose the correct form: "Everyone \_\_\_\_ their work." A. have completed B. has completed C. are completing D. were complete \*\*39.\*\* Which sentence is most likely to be the opening sentence of an arrangement? A. This was unexpected. B. Therefore, the plan failed. C. The committee announced a new plan. D. He then explained it. \*\*40.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. She has seen him yesterday. B. She saw him yesterday. C. She had saw him yesterday. D. She has seeing him yesterday. \*\*41.\*\* Choose the correct word: "He is interested \_\_\_\_ science." A. on B. at C. in D. for \*\*42.\*\* Choose the correct word: "The students \_\_\_\_ ready." A. is B. are C. was D. has \*\*43.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. He asked where was she going. B. He asked where she was going. C. He asked where is she going. D. He asked where going she was. \*\*44.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. Repeat again the answer. B. Repeat the answer. C. Repeat back again the answer. D. Repeated again the answer. \*\*45.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. He discussed about the matter. B. He discussed the matter. C. He discussed on the matter. D. He discussed for the matter. \*\*46.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. She is good in English. B. She is good at English. C. She is good on English. D. She is good by English. \*\*47.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. Neither the teacher nor the students is ready. B. Neither the teacher nor the students are ready. C. Neither the teacher or the students are ready. D. Neither teacher nor students is ready always. \*\*48.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. I have been waiting for two hours. B. I have been waiting since two hours. C. I am waiting since two hours. D. I waited since two hours. \*\*49.\*\* Choose the correct sentence. A. He entered into the room. B. He entered the room. C. He entered in the room. D. He did entered the room. \*\*50.\*\* Choose the best strategy for a difficult sentence-arrangement question. A. Choose the longest sentence first. B. Start with a sentence containing an unexplained pronoun. C. Find opening clues and strong linking pairs first. D. Arrange sentences alphabetically.



## 33. Answer Key

| Q  | Ans | Key Point                        |
|----|-----|----------------------------------|
| 1  | B   | agreement                        |
| 2  | C   | did + V1                         |
| 3  | C   | everyone → singular              |
| 4  | B   | good at                          |
| 5  | B   | no double comparison             |
| 6  | B   | vowel sound                      |
| 7  | C   | perfect + V3                     |
| 8  | B   | parallelism                      |
| 9  | B   | discuss + object                 |
| 10 | C   | subject = quality                |
| 11 | B   | senior to                        |
| 12 | D   | return already includes the idea |
| 13 | D   | discuss + object                 |
| 14 | B   | better                           |
| 15 | C   | parallel V1 forms                |
| 16 | B   | since + starting point           |
| 17 | B   | many + countable plural          |
| 18 | A   | context                          |
| 19 | B   | make a decision                  |
| 20 | B   | vowel sound                      |
| 21 | B   | introduction → action → result   |

| Q  | Ans | Key Point                    |
|----|-----|------------------------------|
| 22 | C   | topic introduction           |
| 23 | C   | result                       |
| 24 | B   | contrast                     |
| 25 | C   | opening sentence             |
| 26 | B   | did + V1                     |
| 27 | C   | did not + V1                 |
| 28 | C   | subject = quality            |
| 29 | B   | collocation                  |
| 30 | B   | statement word order         |
| 31 | B   | object form                  |
| 32 | B   | vowel sound                  |
| 33 | B   | linking verb + adjective     |
| 34 | B   | modal + V1                   |
| 35 | A   | remove redundancy            |
| 36 | B   | parallelism                  |
| 37 | B   | result                       |
| 38 | B   | everyone + singular verb     |
| 39 | C   | topic introduction           |
| 40 | B   | finished past time           |
| 41 | C   | interested in                |
| 42 | B   | plural subject               |
| 43 | B   | indirect-question word order |
| 44 | B   | remove redundancy            |
| 45 | B   | discuss + object             |

| Q  | Ans | Key Point                                   |
|----|-----|---------------------------------------------|
| 46 | B   | good at                                     |
| 47 | B   | nearest subject in common exam construction |
| 48 | A   | for + duration                              |
| 49 | B   | enter + object                              |
| 50 | C   | strong-link method                          |

### Remember

**\*\*Sentence Ability Formula:\*\*** **\*\*Grammar + Meaning + Context + Collocation + Logical Order = Correct Sentence\*\*** For PET, first master the rule, then apply it to correction, improvement, fillers, error detection, and arrangement questions.

## General English — Reading Comprehension

### PET Detailed Notes | English-first | StudyHub Point

**Focus:** Main Idea → Facts → Inference → Vocabulary → Title → Reference → Purpose → Tone → Advanced Question Patterns → Practice

**Hindi Help:** Short support is provided only for difficult reading logic.

## 1. What is Reading Comprehension?

Reading comprehension is the ability to understand a passage, identify important information, interpret the writer's meaning, and answer questions using evidence from the text.

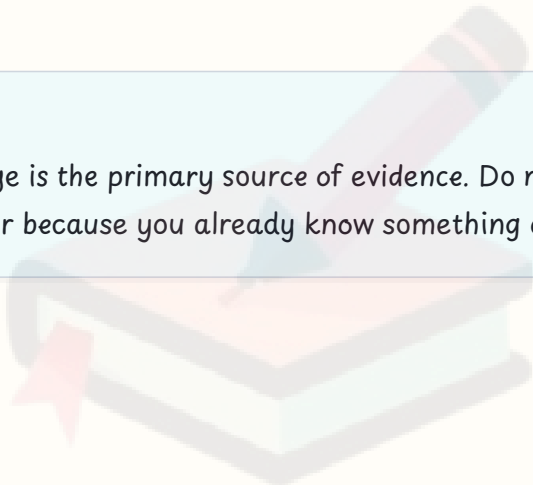
PET comprehension questions may test:

- Main idea / central theme
- Specific facts and details
- Inference and conclusion
- Vocabulary in context

- Synonym/antonym in context
- Suitable title
- Reference of a word/phrase
- Cause and effect
- Sequence/order
- Writer's purpose
- Author's viewpoint
- Tone
- True / False / Not stated style questions
- EXCEPT / NOT / INCORRECT questions
- Sentence-level meaning

 **Exam Tip**

**\*\*Golden Rule:\*\*** The passage is the primary source of evidence. Do not select an answer simply because it is generally true or because you already know something about the topic.



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## 2. Question-Type Master Table

| Question Type    | What it asks                  | Main approach              |
|------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Main Idea        | central message               | whole passage              |
| Central Theme    | broad subject/message         | repeated idea + conclusion |
| Detail/Fact      | explicitly stated information | locate evidence            |
| Inference        | reasonable conclusion         | evidence + logic           |
| Vocabulary       | meaning in context            | surrounding words          |
| Synonym          | closest contextual meaning    | substitution test          |
| Antonym          | opposite contextual meaning   | exact contextual sense     |
| Title            | best overall heading          | main idea + scope          |
| Reference        | what a word refers to         | grammar + logic            |
| Cause/Effect     | reason/result                 | connectors + relationships |
| Sequence         | first/next/last               | time markers               |
| Purpose          | why information is included   | function of passage        |
| Viewpoint        | writer's position             | repeated claims + language |
| Tone             | writer's attitude             | evaluative language        |
| True/False       | whether statement agrees      | direct comparison          |
| Not Stated       | information absent            | evidence check             |
| NOT/EXCEPT       | statement that does not fit   | verify every option        |
| Sentence Meaning | meaning of a specific line    | local + paragraph context  |

## 3. How to Read a Passage

### Step 1 — Preview

Read the title, opening sentence, and, when useful, scan the question set.

### Step 2 — Identify the subject

Ask: **Who/what** is this passage about?

### Step 3 — Track the development

Look for:

- topic sentence
- explanation
- evidence
- example
- contrast
- cause/effect
- conclusion

### Step 4 — Notice connectors

Important connectors include:

**however, therefore, because, although, moreover, consequently, for example, finally.**

### Step 5 — Build a mental map

**Topic → Main claim → Supporting points → Conclusion**

∴ strategy **Read → Understand → Locate evidence → Eliminate → Answer**

Do not depend on memory alone when the passage is available. ∴

## 4. Question-First vs Passage-First Strategy

There is no single method for every passage.

### Passage-first

Useful when the passage is short or the topic is unfamiliar.

### Question-first

Useful when the passage is longer and questions ask for specific details.

### Hybrid Method

For PET, a practical approach is:

1. Quickly understand the topic.
2. Scan the questions.
3. Return to the passage for evidence.
4. Read the relevant paragraph carefully.

#### Exam Tip

Do not follow a strategy rigidly. \*\*Accuracy and textual evidence matter more than the order in which you read.\*\*

## 5. Main Idea vs Central Theme

**Main idea** = the central point the writer communicates.

**Central theme** = the broader subject or message developed throughout the passage.

### Example

A passage discusses how regular exercise improves physical health, mood, sleep, and concentration.

- **Topic:** Exercise
- **Central theme:** Benefits of regular physical activity

- **Main idea:** Regular physical activity has several important benefits for overall well-being.

∴ trap A single example, statistic, person, or minor benefit is usually too narrow to represent the main idea or title. ∴

## 6. Finding the Main Idea

Look for:

1. Repeated concepts
2. Topic sentence
3. Supporting examples
4. Final conclusion
5. Relationship between paragraphs

### ⚡ Trick

Ask: \*\*\*"If I had to explain the whole passage in one sentence, what would I say?"\*\*

## 7. Fact and Detail Questions

A fact/detail question asks for information directly stated or clearly presented.

### Method

1. Identify the keyword.
2. Locate it or its synonym in the passage.
3. Read the surrounding sentence(s).
4. Match the option with the evidence.
5. Reject options that add unsupported information.

### ⚠ Warning

A statement may be true in real life but still be wrong if the passage does not support it.



## 8. Inference Questions

An inference is a conclusion reasonably supported by the passage. It is not a guess or outside knowledge.

### Evidence Ladder

**Textual fact → logical connection → reasonable conclusion**

∴ strategy Ask: **“What is strongly suggested by the evidence?”** rather than “What could possibly be true?” ∴

## 9. Direct vs Inferred Information

| Direct                       | Inferred                      |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| explicitly stated            | logically concluded           |
| little interpretation needed | some reasoning required       |
| words/details appear in text | meaning follows from evidence |

## 10. Negative Inference Questions

Questions may ask:

- Which cannot be inferred?
- Which is NOT implied?
- Which statement is least supported?

### Method

1. Treat every option as a claim.
2. Find evidence for each.
3. Eliminate clearly supported options.

4. Choose the option with no reasonable textual support.

∴ trap Do not choose an option merely because it is unlikely in real life. It must be unsupported by the passage. ∴

## 11. Vocabulary in Context

A word can have different meanings in different contexts.

### Context Method

1. Read the complete sentence.
2. Read before and after it.
3. Identify the part of speech.
4. Substitute each option mentally.
5. Choose the meaning that fits the passage.

The scientist **observed** a change in the sample.

Here **observed** means **noticed/watched carefully**.

### 💡 Exam Tip

Choose the contextual meaning, not the first dictionary meaning you remember.

## 12. Synonym and Antonym Questions in a Passage

For passage-based vocabulary questions, do not use an isolated vocabulary list alone.

### Synonym

Choose the option that can replace the word without changing the intended meaning.

## Antonym

Choose the option that expresses the appropriate opposite meaning in that context.

∴ strategy **Part of speech + context + replacement test = safer vocabulary answer.** ∴

## 13. Reference Questions

Common reference words:

- it
- they
- he/she
- this
- that
- these
- those
- such
- former/latter



### Method

1. Look backward first.
2. Identify grammatically possible antecedents.
3. Check number/person agreement.
4. Check logical meaning.

The city introduced electric buses. **This** reduced pollution.

**This** refers to the introduction/use of electric buses described earlier.

∴ trap The nearest noun is not automatically the correct reference. ∴

## 14. Suitable Title

The best title should:

- represent the whole passage
- capture the central idea
- be concise
- avoid unsupported information

## Title Test

Ask: “Does this title cover most of the passage, not just one paragraph?”

### ⚡ Trick

\*\*Best Title ≈ Main Idea in a short form.\*\*

## 15. Cause and Effect

Common cause markers:

- because
- since
- due to
- owing to
- as

Common effect markers:

- therefore
- hence
- thus
- consequently
- as a result

The river overflowed **because of** continuous rainfall.

Cause → continuous rainfall

Effect → river overflow

## 16. Sequence and Chronology

Look for:

- first
- initially
- then
- next
- later
- afterwards
- finally
- eventually

::: strategy Create a simple mental timeline instead of memorising every sentence word-for-word. :::

## 17. Writer's Purpose

The writer may intend primarily to:

- inform
- explain
- describe
- compare
- persuade
- warn
- criticize
- suggest
- evaluate

### Purpose Test

Ask: **“What job is the passage doing?”**

The purpose should be inferred from the whole passage, not one sentence.

## 18. Author's Viewpoint

Viewpoint is the position or perspective from which the writer discusses a subject.

Look for:

- repeated claims
- recommendations
- criticism
- praise
- qualifications
- comparison between alternatives

### Exam Tip

Do not infer the author's viewpoint from the topic alone. A passage about technology may be supportive, critical, balanced, or cautious.

## 19. Tone

Tone is the writer's attitude.

Common tones:

- neutral
- informative
- positive
- critical
- concerned
- optimistic
- pessimistic
- appreciative
- cautious
- skeptical
- encouraging

Look at adjectives, verbs, evaluations, recommendations, and repeated emotional signals.

### ⚠ Warning

**\*\*Topic ≠ Tone.\*\*** “Pollution” is a topic; “concerned” or “critical” may describe tone.

## 20. Fact vs Opinion

### Fact

Information that can generally be verified.

### Opinion

Belief, judgment, recommendation, or evaluation.

Possible signals include:

- should
- best
- worst
- excellent
- terrible
- I believe
- in my view

Always judge the complete sentence and context.

## 21. True / False / Not Stated

- **True:** clearly supported by the passage.
- **False:** contradicted by the passage.
- **Not Stated:** neither clearly supported nor contradicted.

::: trap **Not stated ≠ false**. If the passage simply does not provide enough information, do not invent a contradiction. :::

## 22. NOT / EXCEPT / INCORRECT Questions

Watch for:

- NOT
- EXCEPT
- FALSE
- INCORRECT
- CANNOT
- NOT TRUE

### Method

1. Highlight the negative word mentally.
2. Check every option against the passage.
3. Mark supported options.
4. Select the option matching the question's negative requirement.

### ⚠ Warning

Many mistakes happen because students find a true option when the question actually asks for the false/incorrect one.

## 23. Sentence-Level Meaning

Sometimes a question asks what a particular sentence means or implies.

### Method

1. Read the target sentence.
2. Read one sentence before and after it.
3. Identify pronouns and connectors.
4. Restate it in simpler English.
5. Choose the option closest to that meaning.

∴ strategy Do not interpret a sentence in isolation when its meaning depends on surrounding context. ∴



## 24. Option Elimination

Eliminate options that are:

1. **Contradictory** — passage says the opposite.
2. **Unsupported** — no evidence.
3. **Too extreme** — stronger than the text.
4. **Too narrow** — only one small detail.
5. **Partly correct** — supported beginning + unsupported addition.
6. **Off-topic** — related words but wrong question focus.

### Formula

**\*\*Best answer = Supported + Relevant + Complete + Correctly worded\*\***

## 25. Extreme Words

Be cautious with:

- always
- never
- all
- none
- completely
- only
- must
- impossible

They are not automatically wrong, but require strong textual support.

## 26. Paragraph Mapping

For longer passages, mentally label:

- **P1:** introduction/topic

- **P2:** explanation/evidence
- **P3:** example/contrast
- **P4:** conclusion/solution

Use the actual passage structure; this is only a mental model.

### ⚡ Trick

**\*\*Keyword → Paragraph → Evidence\*\*** is faster than rereading the complete passage for every detail question.

## 27. Passage Length Strategy

### Short Passage

- Read the complete passage carefully.
- Identify the central idea.
- Answer directly from evidence.

### Medium Passage

- Track paragraph purpose.
- Notice contrasts and examples.
- Return to relevant sections.

### Long Passage

- Build a paragraph map.
- Scan questions for keywords.
- Locate evidence efficiently.
- Avoid unnecessary rereading.

## 28. Difficult Vocabulary During Reading

You do not need to understand every word.

If a word is unfamiliar:

1. Ignore it temporarily.
2. Read surrounding context.
3. Determine whether it affects the question.
4. Infer meaning if necessary.
5. Return only if required.

### Exam Tip

**\*\*One unknown word should not stop the entire passage.\*\*** Understand the overall meaning first.

## 29. Reading Speed vs Accuracy

Improve speed by:

- reading meaningful word groups
- recognising connectors
- locating keywords
- avoiding unnecessary rereading
- practising regularly

Improve accuracy by:

- checking negative words
- returning to evidence
- separating fact from inference
- rejecting extreme options
- verifying the exact question requirement

## 30. Common Comprehension Traps

∴ trap

### Trap 1 — Outside Knowledge

The option is true generally but unsupported by the passage.

### Trap 2 — Detail as Main Idea

A minor fact is selected as the central message.

### Trap 3 — Extreme Option

The option is stronger than the passage's wording.

### Trap 4 — Half-Correct Option

One part is supported, another is invented.

### Trap 5 — Reference Error

A nearby noun is selected without checking logic.

### Trap 6 — Negative Question

NOT/EXCEPT/INCORRECT is overlooked.

### Trap 7 — Not Stated = False

Lack of information is incorrectly treated as contradiction.

### Trap 8 — Tone by Topic

The subject is mistaken for the writer's attitude. ∴

## 31. Hindi Help — Quick Reading Map

| Question   | Hindi clue                          |
|------------|-------------------------------------|
| Main Idea  | पूरे passage का मुख्य विचार         |
| Theme      | passage का व्यापक विषय/संदेश        |
| Fact       | passage में सीधे क्या बताया गया?    |
| Inference  | जानकारी से क्या निष्कर्ष निकलता है? |
| Vocabulary | context में word का अर्थ            |
| Title      | पूरे passage का सबसे उपयुक्त शीर्षक |
| Reference  | this/it/they किसके लिए है?          |
| Cause      | कारण क्या है?                       |
| Effect     | परिणाम क्या है?                     |
| Purpose    | writer यह क्यों बता रहा है?         |
| Tone       | writer का attitude कैसा है?         |
| Not Stated | passage में जानकारी नहीं दी गई      |

## 32. Solved Mini Passage — Main Idea

### Passage

Regular physical activity can improve several aspects of health. It can strengthen the body, support better sleep, and improve mood. Even moderate activity, when performed regularly, can contribute to a healthier lifestyle.

### Question

What is the main idea?

- A. Sleep is the only benefit of exercise.
- B. Regular physical activity has several health benefits.
- C. Only intense exercise is useful.
- D. Exercise is difficult for everyone.

**Answer: B**

**Why?** Several benefits are discussed; sleep is only one detail.

## 33. Solved Mini Passage — Inference

### Passage

The village had received very little rainfall for several months. The wells were drying up, and farmers had begun using water carefully for crops.

### Question

What can reasonably be inferred?

- A. The village was experiencing water scarcity.
- B. The village received record rainfall.
- C. All crops had already failed.
- D. The farmers stopped working completely.

**Answer: A**

**Reason:** Low rainfall + drying wells + careful water use support the inference.

## 34. Solved Mini Passage — Vocabulary

### Passage

The teacher gave a **brief** explanation before the test began.

### Question

The word **brief** most nearly means:

- A. lengthy
- B. short
- C. confusing
- D. difficult

**Answer: B**

## 35. Solved Mini Passage — Reference

### Passage

The city planted more trees along major roads. **This** helped reduce dust and improve the local environment.

### Question

What does **This** refer to?

- A. major roads
- B. dust
- C. planting more trees
- D. the local environment

**Answer: C**

## 36. Solved Mini Passage — Title

### Passage

Digital payments have become increasingly common. They can make transactions faster and reduce the need to carry cash. However, users should remain careful about passwords, suspicious links, and fraudulent messages.

### Question

Which is the most suitable title?

- A. Why Cash Should Disappear Completely
- B. Digital Payments: Benefits and Safety
- C. The History of Banks
- D. Problems With Mobile Phones

**Answer: B**

## 37. Solved Mini Passage — Not Stated

### Passage

The school introduced a reading period every Friday. Students may use the library during this period, and teachers encourage them to choose books according to their interests.

### Question

Which statement is **NOT stated**?

- A. The reading period is held every Friday.
- B. Students may use the library.
- C. Teachers encourage students to choose books according to their interests.
- D. Students receive marks for every book they read.

**Answer: D**

**Why?** The passage does not mention marks for reading books.

## 38. Solved Mini Passage — Tone / Viewpoint

### Passage

Online learning can make educational material accessible to students who live far from major institutions. However, reliable internet access and self-discipline remain important challenges. Therefore, online learning can be valuable, but it works best when learners have appropriate support and resources.



## Questions

1. What is the writer's viewpoint?

- A. Completely against online learning
- B. Completely in favour without any limitation
- C. Balanced, recognising benefits and challenges
- D. Unrelated to online learning

**Answer: C**

2. The tone is best described as:

- A. balanced/cautious
- B. angry
- C. humorous
- D. celebratory

**Answer: A**

## 39. Full Practice Passage 1

### Passage

Trees play an important role in maintaining a healthy environment. They absorb carbon dioxide, release oxygen, provide shade, and support many forms of wildlife. Trees can also help reduce soil erosion by holding soil together with their roots. In urban areas, planting trees can make streets more comfortable and improve the appearance of public spaces. For these reasons, protecting existing trees and increasing green cover are important environmental measures.

## Questions

1. What is the main idea?

- A. Trees are useful only in cities.
- B. Trees provide several environmental benefits and should be protected.
- C. Wildlife is the only reason to plant trees.
- D. Trees prevent all environmental problems.

2. Which benefit is mentioned?

- A. Increasing soil erosion
- B. Reducing oxygen

- C. Providing shade
  - D. Eliminating all pollution
3. How can trees reduce soil erosion?
- A. By increasing rainfall
  - B. By holding soil with their roots
  - C. By removing wildlife
  - D. By covering roads
4. What can be inferred about urban trees?
- A. They can contribute to more comfortable public spaces.
  - B. They are harmful to cities.
  - C. They are useful only for wildlife.
  - D. They have no environmental role.
5. Which title is most suitable?
- A. The Many Benefits of Trees
  - B. Roads and Buildings
  - C. Wildlife Without Trees
  - D. Problems With Soil

## 40. Full Practice Passage 2

### Passage

Many students believe that studying for long hours automatically produces better results. However, the quality of study is often more important than the number of hours spent at a desk. A focused study session with clear goals, short breaks, and active recall can be more useful than several hours of distracted reading. Regular revision also helps students retain information over time. Therefore, an effective study routine should emphasise concentration, active learning, and consistent revision rather than simply increasing study hours.

### Questions

6. What is the main point?
- A. Students should study without breaks.
  - B. Longer study hours always guarantee success.
  - C. Effective study depends on quality, active learning, and consistency.
  - D. Reading is the only useful study method.

**7.** What may be more useful than distracted reading?

- A. A focused study session with clear goals.
- B. Studying all night.
- C. Avoiding revision.
- D. Increasing distractions.

**8.** What does active recall represent here?

- A. Passive rereading only.
- B. An active learning approach.
- C. Taking longer breaks.
- D. Avoiding tests.

**9.** Why is regular revision useful?

- A. It helps retain information over time.
- B. It eliminates the need to study.
- C. It increases distractions.
- D. It makes every session longer.

**10.** Which title best fits the passage?

- A. Study Longer at Any Cost
- B. Effective Study: Quality Over Mere Hours
- C. Why Students Should Avoid Revision
- D. The History of Education

## 41. Full Practice Passage 3

### Passage

Public libraries continue to serve communities even as digital resources become more widely available. A library provides access to books, newspapers, educational material, and sometimes computers or internet facilities. It can also offer a quiet place for study and learning. For students who may not have suitable study resources at home, such facilities can be especially valuable. Digital technology has changed how people access information, but it has not removed the need for shared public learning spaces.

### Questions

**11.** What is the central idea?

- A. Digital technology has made libraries useless.
- B. Public libraries continue to provide valuable learning resources and spaces.
- C. Libraries contain only newspapers.
- D. Students should never use digital resources.

**12.** Which facility is mentioned?

- A. Sports stadiums
- B. Computers or internet facilities
- C. Hospitals
- D. Transport services

**13.** Why may libraries be especially valuable for some students?

- A. They provide suitable study resources and spaces.
- B. They guarantee exam success.
- C. They replace teachers completely.
- D. They prevent access to digital information.

**14.** What does “such facilities” refer to?

- A. Digital technology only
- B. Study resources and facilities provided by libraries
- C. Newspapers only
- D. Homes

**15.** Which statement is supported?

- A. Digital resources have completely replaced libraries.
- B. Libraries can still function as shared public learning spaces.
- C. Libraries are useful only for children.
- D. Libraries provide no access to technology.

## 42. Full Practice Passage 4

### Passage

Water conservation is not only a responsibility of large institutions. Households can also reduce unnecessary water use through simple habits such as repairing leaking taps, using water carefully while washing, and reusing suitable water for plants. These actions may appear small individually, but when adopted by many households they can reduce wastage significantly. Conservation therefore depends both on public systems and on responsible everyday behaviour.

### Questions

**16.** What is the central message?

- A. Only institutions can conserve water.
- B. Household habits can contribute meaningfully to water conservation.
- C. Water conservation requires expensive technology in every home.
- D. Small actions have no value.

**17.** Which action is mentioned?

- A. Leaving taps open
- B. Repairing leaking taps
- C. Increasing water wastage
- D. Avoiding plants

**18.** What can be inferred?

- A. Collective small actions can have a significant effect.
- B. Household behaviour never matters.
- C. Public systems are unnecessary.
- D. Water conservation is impossible.

**19.** The phrase “these actions” refers to:

- A. public systems only
- B. everyday water-saving habits
- C. institutions
- D. expensive technology

**20.** Which title is best?

- A. Water Conservation: Everyday Responsibility
- B. Why Water Should Be Wasted
- C. Large Institutions Only
- D. The History of Water

## 43. Full Practice Passage 5

### Passage

Public transport can reduce the number of private vehicles on roads when it is reliable, affordable, and convenient. Buses and trains can carry many passengers at once, potentially reducing traffic pressure and fuel consumption per passenger. However, simply increasing the number of vehicles is not enough. Public transport systems also require good scheduling, maintenance, safety, and convenient connections so that people are willing to use them regularly.

### Questions

**21.** What is the main idea?

- A. Public transport is useful only when it is expensive.
- B. Effective public transport can reduce road pressure when supported by reliable services.

- C. Private vehicles should never be used.
- D. More buses alone solve every transport problem.

**22.** Which condition is mentioned as important?

- A. Unreliable service
- B. High fares only
- C. Good scheduling and maintenance
- D. Fewer connections

**23.** Why can buses and trains reduce traffic pressure?

- A. They carry many passengers at once.
- B. They increase private vehicles.
- C. They stop all road traffic.
- D. They remove the need for roads.

**24.** Which statement is NOT supported?

- A. Reliability can affect willingness to use public transport.
- B. Maintenance is important.
- C. Simply increasing vehicle numbers is always sufficient.
- D. Convenient connections can encourage use.

**25.** The writer's tone is best described as:

- A. balanced and practical
- B. angry
- C. humorous
- D. completely dismissive

## 44. Full Practice Passage 6

### Passage

Reading fiction can provide entertainment, but its value may extend beyond relaxation. Stories can expose readers to unfamiliar situations, perspectives, and emotions. By following characters with different experiences, readers may develop greater awareness of how other people think and feel. This does not mean that every story produces the same effect, but regular engagement with varied narratives can encourage reflection and empathy.

### Questions

**26.** What is the main idea?

- A. Fiction is useful only for entertainment.

- B. Fiction can provide entertainment and may also encourage perspective-taking and empathy.
- C. Every story produces exactly the same effect.
- D. Fiction should replace all other forms of learning.

**27.** What may stories expose readers to?

- A. Only familiar situations
- B. Unfamiliar situations, perspectives, and emotions
- C. Only factual information
- D. Only historical dates

**28.** What does "This" in the passage refer to?

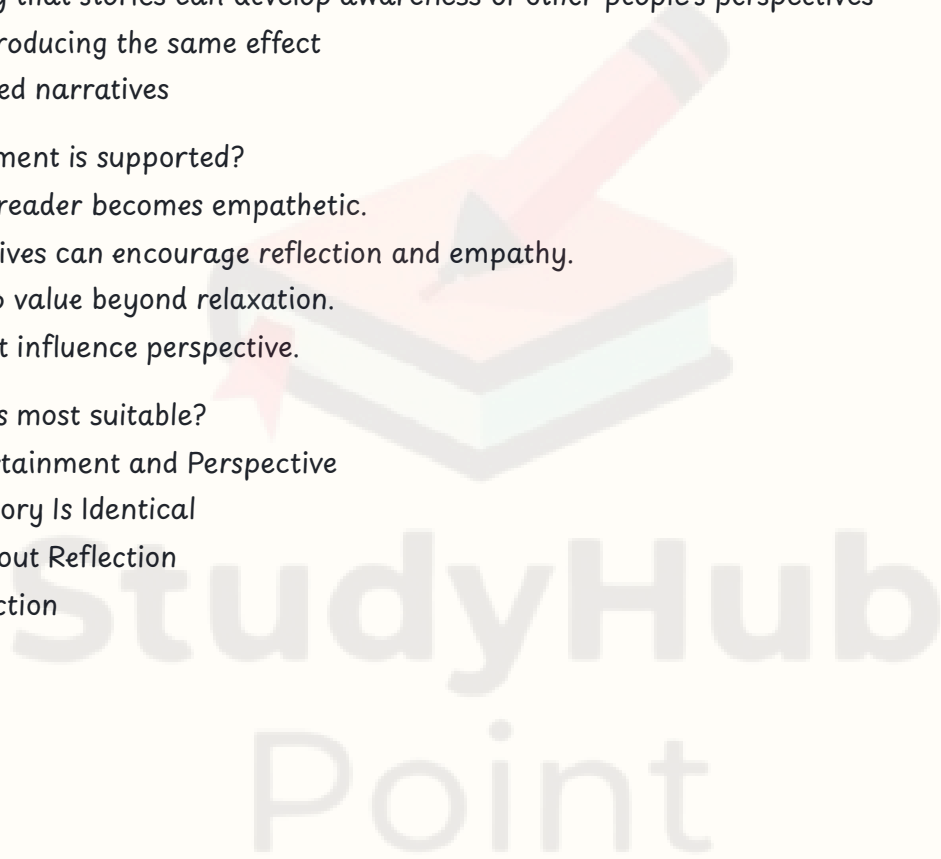
- A. Reading only for entertainment
- B. The possibility that stories can develop awareness of other people's perspectives
- C. Every story producing the same effect
- D. Avoiding varied narratives

**29.** Which statement is supported?

- A. Every fiction reader becomes empathetic.
- B. Varied narratives can encourage reflection and empathy.
- C. Fiction has no value beyond relaxation.
- D. Stories cannot influence perspective.

**30.** Which title is most suitable?

- A. Fiction: Entertainment and Perspective
- B. Why Every Story Is Identical
- C. Reading Without Reflection
- D. The End of Fiction



## 45. Answer Key — Full Practice

| Q  | Ans | Skill               |
|----|-----|---------------------|
| 1  | B   | Main idea           |
| 2  | C   | Fact                |
| 3  | B   | Detail              |
| 4  | A   | Inference           |
| 5  | A   | Title               |
| 6  | C   | Main idea           |
| 7  | A   | Detail              |
| 8  | B   | Context             |
| 9  | A   | Detail              |
| 10 | B   | Title               |
| 11 | B   | Main idea           |
| 12 | B   | Fact                |
| 13 | A   | Inference/detail    |
| 14 | B   | Reference           |
| 15 | B   | Supported statement |
| 16 | B   | Main idea           |
| 17 | B   | Fact                |
| 18 | A   | Inference           |
| 19 | B   | Reference           |
| 20 | A   | Title               |
| 21 | B   | Main idea           |



| Q  | Ans | Skill               |
|----|-----|---------------------|
| 22 | C   | Detail              |
| 23 | A   | Cause/effect        |
| 24 | C   | NOT supported       |
| 25 | A   | Tone                |
| 26 | B   | Main idea           |
| 27 | B   | Detail              |
| 28 | B   | Reference           |
| 29 | B   | Supported statement |
| 30 | A   | Title               |

## 46. Advanced Mixed Practice — Question Patterns

### Passage A

Community gardens can transform unused urban spaces into productive and social areas. Residents may grow vegetables, flowers, and herbs while also meeting neighbours and learning basic gardening skills. Such gardens do not solve every urban problem, but they can contribute to local food awareness, community interaction, and greener surroundings.

**31.** The main idea is:

- A. Community gardens solve every urban problem.
- B. Community gardens can provide several environmental and social benefits.
- C. Urban residents should grow only vegetables.
- D. Gardening is mainly a commercial activity.

**32.** What does “**Such gardens**” refer to?

- A. unused spaces
- B. community gardens

- C. urban problems
- D. vegetables

**33.** Which statement is NOT supported?

- A. Gardens may encourage interaction among residents.
- B. Gardens may provide learning opportunities.
- C. Gardens completely solve urban problems.
- D. Gardens can make surroundings greener.

**34.** The writer's viewpoint is best described as:

- A. positive but qualified
- B. completely negative
- C. unrelated
- D. sarcastic

## Passage B

Many people assume that taking notes means writing down nearly everything a speaker says. Effective notes, however, usually involve selecting important ideas, organising them clearly, and using short forms where appropriate. The purpose of note-taking is not to create a complete transcript but to create a useful record that helps later recall.

**35.** What is the main point?

- A. Every spoken word should be written down.
- B. Effective note-taking involves selecting and organising important information.
- C. Short forms should never be used.
- D. Note-taking is unnecessary.

**36.** What does “**however**” signal?

- A. addition
- B. contrast
- C. cause
- D. sequence

**37.** According to the passage, the purpose of note-taking is to:

- A. create a complete transcript
- B. help later recall through a useful record
- C. copy every sentence exactly
- D. avoid organising information

**38.** Which statement is most strongly supported?

- A. More words always mean better notes.
- B. Selective notes can be more useful than a complete transcript.
- C. Note-taking requires no judgment.
- D. Speakers should pause after every sentence.

## Passage C

A town introduced a bicycle-sharing programme near major transit stations. During the first few months, usage was modest because many residents were unfamiliar with the system. After clearer signs were installed and information about membership became easier to access, more people began using the bicycles. The change suggests that convenience and information can influence whether people adopt a new public service.

**39.** Why was early usage modest?

- A. Bicycles were unavailable.
- B. Residents were unfamiliar with the system.
- C. Transit stations were closed.
- D. Membership was compulsory.

**40.** What happened after clearer signs and information were provided?

- A. Usage increased.
- B. The programme ended.
- C. Stations were removed.
- D. Residents stopped cycling.

**41.** What can reasonably be inferred?

- A. Information and convenience may affect adoption of a service.
- B. All residents prefer bicycles.
- C. Signs alone guarantee success.
- D. Public services never need promotion.

**42.** Which title is most suitable?

- A. Factors Affecting Adoption of a Bicycle-Sharing Service
- B. Why Bicycles Are Dangerous
- C. The History of Transit Stations
- D. Membership Fees Only

## Passage D

A museum exhibition compared traditional tools with modern automated equipment. Rather than presenting one as universally superior, the exhibition showed how different tools suit different tasks. Traditional tools may offer simplicity and direct control, while automated systems can increase speed and consistency. The exhibition therefore encouraged visitors to think about suitability rather than assuming that newer technology is always better.

**43.** What is the central message?

- A. Traditional tools are always better.
- B. Modern equipment is always better.
- C. The appropriate tool depends on the task.
- D. Museums should avoid technology.

**44.** The tone is:

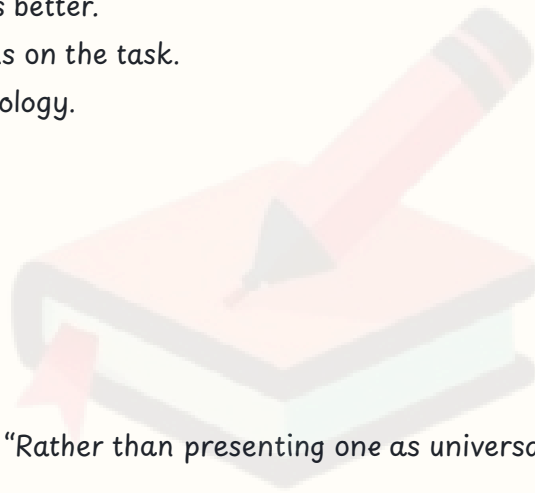
- A. balanced and analytical
- B. angry
- C. humorous
- D. fearful

**45.** What does “one” refer to in “Rather than presenting one as universally superior”?

- A. one task
- B. either type of tool
- C. one museum
- D. one visitor

**46.** Which statement is NOT supported?

- A. Traditional tools may provide direct control.
- B. Automated systems may increase speed.
- C. Newer technology is always better.
- D. Different tasks may require different tools.



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## 47. Advanced Practice Answer Key

| Q  | Ans | Skill              |
|----|-----|--------------------|
| 31 | B   | Main idea          |
| 32 | B   | Reference          |
| 33 | C   | NOT supported      |
| 34 | A   | Viewpoint/tone     |
| 35 | B   | Main idea          |
| 36 | B   | Connector/contrast |
| 37 | B   | Detail             |
| 38 | B   | Inference          |
| 39 | B   | Fact               |
| 40 | A   | Fact               |
| 41 | A   | Inference          |
| 42 | A   | Title              |
| 43 | C   | Central message    |
| 44 | A   | Tone               |
| 45 | B   | Reference          |
| 46 | C   | NOT supported      |

## 48. Final Reading Strategy

### Remember

### Before reading Understand the topic and question requirement. ### While reading Follow the main idea, paragraph purpose, connectors, examples, contrasts, and conclusions. ### While answering Locate evidence, eliminate unsupported/extreme options, and distinguish fact from inference. ### Before marking Check whether the question asks **\*\*TRUE, FALSE, NOT, EXCEPT, or INCORRECT\*\***.

## 49. Quick Revision Checklist

- ☐ Identify the main idea.
- ☐ Distinguish main idea from central theme.
- ☐ Separate main idea from supporting details.
- ☐ Locate explicit facts.
- ☐ Make only evidence-based inferences.
- ☐ Handle negative inference questions carefully.
- ☐ Use context for vocabulary.
- ☐ Solve contextual synonym/antonym questions.
- ☐ Trace pronoun/reference words.
- ☐ Select a title covering the whole passage.
- ☐ Identify cause and effect.
- ☐ Follow chronological order.
- ☐ Identify writer's purpose and viewpoint.
- ☐ Recognise tone.
- ☐ Distinguish fact, opinion, and not-stated information.
- ☐ Watch negative question words.
- ☐ Eliminate extreme/unsupported options.
- ☐ Adjust strategy according to passage length.

### Formula

**\*\*Reading Comprehension Formula:\*\*** **\*\*Understand → Map → Locate evidence → Eliminate traps → Verify → Answer\*\***



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